
Mors Iosephi † THE DEATH OF JOSEPH

The work here presented should be considered preliminary: there is a considerable amount of work that could (and should) be done in terms of adding relevant critical notes for the Coptic text, which itself needs to be properly proofread.

INTRODUCTION

The account of the *Death of Joseph* (aka the *History of Joseph the Carpenter*) recounts the glorification of St Joseph and his feast day; his cult, so popular in the West, was long confined to Egypt. A major interest in it lies in a few reminiscences of earlier books, and in the picturesque and highly Egyptian descriptions of death. The lamentations of Joseph and his prayers find many parallels in the literature of Christian Egypt, and especially in the Coptic accounts of the death of the Virgin Mary. Significant portions of the text are based on material found in the *Protoevangelium of James*.

A complete manuscript exists in Bohairic Coptic (the text presented herein) and significant fragments also exist in Sahidic. We have an early Arabic translation, which was itself translated into Latin, originally in the 14th Century; we present [Tischendorf's 1853 Latin](#) text in this collection. The English text presented is heavily based on [Forbes Robinson's 1896 translation](#).

AUTHORSHIP AND DATES

The book was almost certainly written in Egypt (or, at least, by an Egyptian Christian), though it is unclear if the original language was Coptic or Greek. Although the text implies that it was written by (one of) the apostles, it dates from no earlier than the 4th Century, though some consider it a compilation from various sources, made in the 6th/7th Century.

PROLOGUE

φαι πε πιχνη έβοληεν σωμα ντε πενωτ ιωσηφ πιαμωε,
φιωτ μπικιστος κατα σαρξ, φε ετ αφερ ρια νρομπι ηεν
πεφωνη, ε α πενωτηρ ταμε νιαποστολος επεφβιος τηρ
ριχεν πιτωου ντε νιχωιτ: α νιαποστολος ρωου ρηαι νηαι
σαχι, αχαγ ηεν τβυβλιοθηκη ηεν ιερογσαλημ: ουορ ον δε
περοου ετ α πιηελλο εθ ουαβ χα σωμα εηρηι νηητη, πε
σογκς νπιαβοτ επηη ηεν ουριρηνη ντε φνωγτ. αμην.

This is the going forth from the body of our father Joseph the
carpenter, the father of Christ according to flesh, whose life was
one hundred and eleven years.ⁱ Our Saviour told the apostles his
whole life on the mount of Olives, and the apostles also wrote
these words, and left them in the Library at Jerusalem. And
again, the day on which the holy old man laid down the body is
the twenty sixth of the month Epep; in the peace of God, Amen.

PROLOGUE

ⁱ Literally translated, the sentence ends, “*who spent one hundred and eleven years in his life.*”

DEATH OF JOSEPH 1

¹ ἁσῶπι ΔΕ ΝΟΥΕΞΟΥ, ΕΡΕ ΠΕΝΘΩΤΗΡ ΝΑΓΑΘΟΣ ΖΕΜΙ ΕΧΕΝ ΠΙΤΩΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΝΙΧΩΙΤ, ΕΡΕ ΝΕΦΜΑΘΗΤΗΣ ΘΟΥΗΤ ΕΡΟΦ, ΑΦΑΧΙ ΝΕΜΩΟΥ ΕΦΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ | ΧΕ Ω ΝΑΣΝΗΟΥ ΜΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΟΥΟΖ ΝΙΩΗΡΙ ΝΤΕ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΝΑΓΑΘΟΣ ΝΗ ΕΤ ΑΦΟΤΠΠΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΟΥΤΕ ΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΤΗΡΦ:
² ΤΕΤΕΝΣΩΟΥΝ ΧΕ ΙΣ ΟΥΜΗΩ ΝΣΟΠ ΔΙΤΑΜΩΤΕΝ ΧΕ ΖΩΤ ΕΡΟΙ ΠΕ, ΝΤΟΥΕΡ ΣΤΑΥΡΩΝΙΝ ΜΜΟΙ, ΟΥΟΖ ΝΤΑΧΕΜ ΤΠΙ ΜΦΜΟΥ ΉΔ ΠΙ-Ε ΠΤΗΡΦ, ΝΤΑΤΩΝΤ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΝΗ ΕΘ ΜΩΟΥΤ, ΝΤΑΤ ΝΩΤΕΝ ΜΠΙΖΙΩΩ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΕΓΑΓΓΕΛΙΟΝ ΧΕ, ΖΙΝΑ ΝΤΕΤΕΝΖΙΩΩ ΜΜΟΦ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΤΗΩΦ, ΝΤΑΤ ΖΙ ΘΗΝΟΥ ΝΟΥΧΟΜ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΠΙΣΙ, ΝΤΑΜΑΖΘΗΝΟΥ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΟΥΠΝΕΥΜΑ ΕΦΟΥΑΒ, ΝΤΕΤΕΝΖΙΩΩ ΝΝΙΕΘΝΟΣ ΤΗΡΟΥ, ΕΡΕΤΕΝΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΝΩΟΥ ΧΕ ΔΡΙ ΜΕΤΑΝΟΙΝ, ³ ΧΕ ΝΑΝΕ ΟΥΔΑΦΟΤ ΜΜΩΟΥ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΕΩΝ ΕΘ ΝΗΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΡΩΜΙ ΧΕΜΦ ΕΖΟΤΕ ΝΙΧΡΗΜΑ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΤΗΡΦ, ⁴ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ΝΑΝΕ ΟΥΩΝΤΑΤΣΙ ΝΟΥΩΤ ΉΕΝ ΠΠΙ ΜΠΑΙΩΤ ΕΖΟΤΕ ΤΜΕΤΡΑΜΑΔ ΤΗΡΣ ΝΤΕ ΠΑΙ ΚΟΣΜΟΣ, ⁵ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ΝΑΝΕ ΟΥΟΥΝΟΥ ΝΟΥΩΤ ΝΤΕ ΝΙΘΜΗ ΕΥΡΑΩΙ ΕΖΟΤΕ ΟΥΩΟ ΝΡΟΜΠ ΝΤΕ | ΝΙΡΕΦΕΡΝΟΒΙ ΕΥΡΙΜΙ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΥΝΕΖΠ, ΝΤΟΥΩΤΕΜΦΩΤ-ΕΒΟΛ ΝΝΟΥΕΡΜΩΟΥΙ ΟΥΔΕ ΝΤΟΥΩΤΕΜΤ ΖΘΗΟΥ ΕΡΩΟΥ ΕΠΤΗΡΦ. ⁶ ΤΝΟΥ ΧΕ, Ω ΝΑΜΕΛΟΣ ΕΤ ΤΑΙΗΟΥΤ, ΔΡΕΤΕΝΩΑΝ ΩΕ ΝΩΤΕΝ, ΖΙΩΩ ΝΩΟΥ ΧΕ ΟΥΜΑΩΙ

¹ Now, it came to pass on a day, as our good Saviour was sitting on the mount of Olives and his disciples were assembled to him, that he spoke with them, saying, "O my brothers beloved and you sons of my good Father, whom he has chosen from among the whole world. ² You know that, many times now, I have told you that I must be crucified and taste death for the universe, and rise from the dead, and give you the preaching of the gospel, that you may preach it in all the world, and clothe you with power from on high, and fill you with the Holy Spirit, that you may preach to all the nations, saying to them, 'Repent; ³ for, it is better that a man finds a cup of water in the age that is coming than all the riches of all the world.' ⁴ And again, 'Better is a single footstep in my Father's house than all the wealth of this world.' ⁵ And again, 'Better is a single hour of the righteous rejoicing than a thousand years of the sinners weeping and mourning, whose tears shall not be wiped away, neither shall they be heeded at all.' ⁶ Now, therefore, O my glorious members, when you go, preach to them, saying, 'A just balance and a just measure are

DEATH OF JOSEPH 1

¹ Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns that refer to Jesus/God.

² The literal translation of 'the Holy Spirit' is 'a holy spirit'.

³ Literally, this verse reads, "better is a cup of water in the age that is coming, that the man finds it than all the riches in the world."

⁴ Here, the 'Father's house' likely refers to the Temple.

⁵ But cf. Luke 5:7 & 15:10.

⁶ Another reading for 'glorious' is 'honourable'.

ἵλικεον νεν οὐφί μλκεον νε ἵν ἔτε παϊωτ ναςεκ λογος
νενωτεν ἵηντοῦ, οὐορ ον δε σεναφινι ἵσα οὐσαχι ἵοῦωτ
ἵσι-ζραφ ἵτεν ὀηνοῦ ἐρετενναχοφ. ⁷ μφρητ ἔτε ἡμον να-ω-
ερ-έβολ ἵτοτφ ἵφμοῦ αν, παι ρητ ἵμον ζλι να-ω-ερ-έβολ ἵνζ
ετ αφαιτοῦ, ἵτε οὐαγαθον ἵτε οὐπετρωοῦ. ⁸ πλην ναι σαχι
τηροῦ ετ αἰχοτοῦ νωτεν τνοῦ, δε ἵμον ζλι ἵχωρι
ναωνοzem αν εθε τεφχομ, οὐδε ἵμον οὐρωμι ναωνοzem αν
εθε παωαι ἵτε τεφμετραμαό. ⁹ τνοῦ δε σωτεμ, ἵταχω
έωτεν ἵφβιος ἐπαϊωτ ἱωσνφ πτῆλλο ἵζαμφε ετ σαρωοῦτ.

those with which my Father will take account with you.’ And
again, ‘A single word of jest that you shall speak shall be
required of you.’ ⁷ Even as no one can escape death, so no one
can escape those things which he has done, whether *it is* good
or evil. ⁸ But all these words have I told you now, *saying*, ‘No
mighty one can be saved because of his strength, neither can
a man be saved because of the multitude of his wealth.’
⁹ Now, therefore, hear, and I will tell you the life of my father
Joseph, the blessed old man *who was* a carpenter.

⁷ The words, ‘*it is*’, do not occur in the MS but are implied.

⁸ The word, ‘*saying*’, here following Robinson, does not occur in the MS.

⁹ The words, ‘*who was a*’, do not occur in the MS but are implied.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 2

¹ ΝΕ ΟΥΟΝ ΟΥΡΩΜΑ ΧΕ ΙΩΧΗΦ ΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΠΕ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΒΑΚΙ ΧΕ | ΒΗΘΛΕΕΜ, Ε ΘΑ ΝΠΟΥΔΑΙ ΤΕ, ΟΥΟΖ ΘΒΑΚΙ ΝΠΟΥΡΟ ΔΑΥΙΔ ΤΕ.
² ΟΥΟΖ ΑΓΤΣΑΒΟ ΝΚΑΛΩΣ ΕΤΣΟΦΙΑ ΝΕΜ ΤΤΕΧΝΗ ΝΤΕ ΤΜΕΤΑΜΩΕ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ ΠΑΙ ΡΩΜΙ ΧΕ ΙΩΧΗΦ ΑΦΣΙ ΝΑΦ ΝΟΥΣΖΙΜΙ ΚΑΤΑ ΟΥΧΙΝΜΟΥΧΤ ΝΤΕ ΟΥΓΑΜΟΣ ΕΦΟΥΑΒ, ΟΥΟΖ ΑΣΜΙΣΙ ΝΑΦ ΝΖΑΝΩΗΡΙ ΝΕΜ ΖΑΝΩΕΡΙ, Δ ΝΩΗΡΙ ΝΖΩΟΥΤ ΝΕΜ ΣΝΟΥΤ ΝΩΕΡΙ ΝΣΖΙΜΙ, ΕΤΕ ΝΑΙ ΝΕ ΝΟΥΡΑΝ: ΙΟΥΔΑΣ ΝΕΜ ΙΩΧΗΤΟΣ, ΙΑΚΩΒΟΣ ΝΕΜ ΣΙΜΟΝ: ΦΡΑΝ ΝΝΕΦΩΕΡΙ ΝΣΖΙΜΙ ΠΕ ΛΥΣΙΑ ΝΕΜ ΛΥΔΙΑ.
⁴ ΟΥΟΖ ΤΣΖΙΜΙ ΝΙΩΧΗΦ ΑΣΜΟΥ ΚΑΤΑ ΦΡΗΤ ΕΤ ΘΗΩ ΝΡΩΜΙ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΟΥΟΖ ΑΔΧΩ ΝΙΑΚΩΒΟΣ ΕΦΟΙ ΝΚΟΥΧΙ. ⁵ ΙΩΧΗΦ ΔΕ ΝΕ ΟΥΘΜΗ ΠΕ, ΕΦΤ ΩΟΥ ΝΦΝΟΥΤ ΉΕΝ ΖΩΒ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΟΥΟΖ ΝΑΦΙ ΝΒΟΛ ΠΕ, ΕΦΕΡ ΖΩΒ ΕΤΤΕΧΝΗ ΝΤΕ ΤΜΕΤΖΑΜΩΕ, ΝΘΟΥ ΝΕΜ ΠΕΦΩΗΡΙ Β, ΕΥΟΝΗ ΕΠΖΩΒ ΝΤΕ ΝΟΥΧΙΧ ΚΑΥΑ ΦΝΟΜΟΣ ΝΜΩΥΧΗ. ⁶ ΟΥΟΖ ΠΑΙ ΡΩΜΙ ΝΘΜΗ Ε ΤΣΑΧΙ ΕΘΒΗΤΦ, ΦΑΙ ΠΕ ΙΩΧΗΦ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΚΑΤΑ ΣΑΡΖ, ΦΗ ΕΤ ΑΥΩΠ ΝΣΑ ΤΑΜΑΥ ΜΑΡΙΑ ΝΑΦ ΕΥΣΖΙΜΙ.

¹ There was a man Joseph who was from a city *called* Bethlehem, which is the *city* of the Jews, and is the city of king David. ² And he learned well the wisdom and the trade of carpentry. ³ And this man Joseph took to himself a wife, according to a union of a holy marriage. And she bore him sons and daughters, four sons and two daughters; whose names are these, Judas and Josetos, James and Simon; and the names of his daughters are Lysia and Lydia. ⁴ And Joseph's wife died, even as it is appointed for all men, and left James still little. ⁵ And Joseph was a righteous man, glorifying God in all things. And he was outside, working at the trade of carpentry, he and his two sons, living by the work of their hands, according to the law of Moses. ⁶ And this righteous man, of whom I speak, this is Joseph my father according to flesh, to whom my mother Mary was betrothed for a wife.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 2

- ¹ The literal translation of '*who was*' is '*he is*'.
² Lagarde notes that the dot on the initial letter of *ἡκαλωσ* is not present in the MS.
³ For '*the names oh his daughters are*', the MS has '*the name of his daughter(s) is*'.
⁴ Literally translated, the verse ends, "*and James being little.*"
⁵ Cf. Mk 15:40.
⁶ Cf. Mt 1:18, Lk 1:27.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 3

¹ | ΟΥΟΖ ΉΕΝ ΠΧΙΝΘΡΕ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΗΦ ΖΕΜCΙ ΕΦΟΙ ΝΧΗΡΑ, ΜΑΡΙΑ ΖΩC ΤΑΜΑΥ, ΘΑ ΝΙCΜΟΤ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΕΘ ΝΑΝΕΥ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΤ CΗΑΡΩΟΥΤ, ΝΑCΩΟΠ ΠΕ ΉΕΝ ΠΕΡΦΕΥ ΕCΩΕΜΩΙ ΝΉΝΤQ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΤΟΥΒΟ, Ε ΑCΕΡ ΝΙΩΤ QΑ ΙΒ ΝΡΟΜΠ, ΑCΕΡ ΖΤ ΝΡΟΜΠ ΉΕΝ ΠΗΙ ΝΤΕ ΠCΟΙC. ² ΤΟΤΕ ΝΙΟΥΗΒ ΉΕΝ ΠΧΙΝΘΡΟΥ ΝΑΥ ΕΤΠΑΡΘΕΝΟC ΕCΕΡ ΑCΚΙΝ ΟΥΟΖ ΕCΩΟΠ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΖΟΤ ΝΤΕ ΠCΟΙC ΑΥCΑΧΙ ΝΕΜ ΝΟΥΕΡΗΟΥ ΕΥΧΩ ΜΜΟC ΧΕ ΜΑΡΕΝΩΙΝΙ ΝCΑ ΟΥΡΩΜΙ Ε ΝΑΝΕQ, ΝΤΕΝΩΕΠ ΤΟΤC ΝΑQ QΑ ΠCΗΟΥ ΝΠΙΖΟΠ, ΧΕ ΜΗΠΩC ΝΤΕΝΧΑC, ΝΤΕ ΠCΩΝΤ ΝΝΙCΙΟΜΙ QΩΠΙ ΜΜΟC ΉΕΝ ΠΕΡΦΕΙ, ΝΤΕΝΩΩΠΕ ΉΑ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΝΟΒΙ.

¹ And, while my father Joseph lived as a widower, Mary also my mother, who was in every way good and blessed, was dwelling in the temple, serving therein in purity, and she grew up until she was twelve years old. She spent three years in the house of her parents, and nine other years in the temple of the Lord. ² Then the priests, when they saw the Virgin living austere and dwelling in the fear of the Lord, spoke one with another, saying, "Let us seek a good man and espouse her to him until the time of the marriage feast; lest by any means we let the custom of women happen to her in the temple, and we come to be under a great sin."

DEATH OF JOSEPH 3

¹ The literal translation of 'who was in every way good and blessed' is 'she of all the good and blessed manners'.

² For 'the fear', the MS has 'a fear'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 4

¹ ҺЕН ҢОҢНОУ ДЕ ӨТЕММАҢ АҢМОҢТ ӨТӨҢЛН НТЕ ИҢДА, АҢНИ-
ӨВОЛ НҺНТС МІВ НЛАОС КАТА ФРАН НТІВ НФҢЛН НТЕ ПИСРАНЛ
² А ПІКЛНРОС І ЕХЕН ФА ТМЕТҺЕЛЛО ӨӨ НАНЕС ИОСНФ ПАИОТ
КАТА САРЗ. ³ ТОТЕ НИОҢНВ АҢЕР ОҢО, ПЕХОУОҢ НТАМАҢ ӨТ
СМАРОУОТ НПАӨӨНОС ХЕ МОҢИ НЕМ ИОСНПГ, | СӨТЕМ НСӨҢ
ҢАТЕ ПІСНОҢ ҢОПИ НТЕНЕР ПЕЗОП. ⁴ А ПАИОТ ИОСНФ БИ НМАРИА
ТАМАҢ ӨҺОҢН ӨПӨҚНИ, АСИНИ НПІКОҢХИ НАЛОҢ ИАКОВОС ӨҢ ЗЕН
ПӨКЕМ НТМЕТӨРФАНОС, НАСЕР ӨАЛПИН НМОҢ ПЕ: ӨӨВЕ ФАИ
АҢМОҢТ ӨРОС ХЕ МАРИА НТЕ ИАКОВОС. ⁵ ЛОИПОН ӨТ А ИОСНФ ОЛС
ӨҺОҢН ӨПӨҚНИ, АҢӨӨ НАҢ ӨПИМОТ ӨТ ӨҢЕР ЗОВ НҺНТҢ ҺЕН
ӨМЕТЗАНӨӨ. ⁶ АСЕР РОМПИ СОУОТ ҺЕН ПӨҚНИ НХЕ МАРИА ТАМАҢ
ҢА ПІСНОҢ ӨӨ НАНӨҢ.

1 And, in that hour, they called the tribe of Judah, and brought out twelve peoples, according to the name of the twelve tribes of Israel. **2** The lot fell on the good old man Joseph, my father according to flesh. **3** Then the priests answered and said to my blessed virgin mother, "Go with Joseph, obey him, until the time comes that we make the marriage feast." **4** My father Joseph received Mary my mother into his house. She found the little boy James in the sadness of bereavement and was cherishing him. So, she was called Mary of James. **5** Now, Joseph took her into his house; and he went to the place in which he worked in carpentry. **6** Mary my mother spent two years in his house until the good time.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 4

- 1 In place of ‘*in that hour*’, here following the *MS*, Robinson has ‘*straightway*’.
2 The literal translation of ‘*fell*’ is ‘*came*’.
3 The punctuation (Coptic) in the latter part of this verse is not certain.
4 This name for Mary is not mentioned elsewhere.
5 The *MS* has the verb translated ‘*worked*’ in the present tense.
6 The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus* CXVI, begins at the end of this verse (ἐγκαῖρος ἐτηανοῦγ – ‘*to the good time*’).

DEATH OF JOSEPH 5

¹ ἡζρηι δε ἦεν ἱμαξηλ ἡρομπε ἡτε πεσωνῆ λι ἦεν παούωω
ἡμιν ἡμοι, αἰωσπι ἡῆντε, ἀνοκ πε ἡσογς πετενωῆ. ² ἦεν
πλινῶρεσ ἐρ γ̅ δε ἡαβοτ ἐσῆβοκι ἀ πατχροϩ ἡωσῆ ἡ ἐβολῆεν
πῡωιτ ἐτ ἐφερ ῆωβ ἡῆντϩ ἦεν ἱμετῆαμωε, ἀσῆιμι ἡταμαγ
ἡπαρῶενος ἐ ἀσερ βοκι, ἀφῶορτερ ογῶρ ἀφερ ῆοτ, ἀφοσῆι
ἐχας ἐβολ ἡχωπ. ³ ογῶρ ἐβολῆεν πῡκαῆ ἡῆντ ἡπεφογωμ
ογδε ἡπεφω.

¹ Now, in the fourteenth year of her life, I came by My own will
and dwelt in her, I who am Jesus your life. ² Now, when she
was three months pregnant, the guileless Joseph came from the
place in which he worked in carpentry and found my virgin
mother pregnant. He was troubled and feared, and he planned
to put her away privately. ³ And, from grief of heart, he did not
eat or drink.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 5

¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXVI*, lacks the name, 'Jesus' (ἡσογς).

² The MS has the verb translated 'worked' in the present tense.

³ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXVI*, expands this verse: *And from sorrow he lay down, and he did not eat anything at all in that evening.*

DEATH OF JOSEPH 6

¹ ԵՆ ԺԲԱԿԻ ԴԵ ՆԵՒԵ ՍԵՐՍԻ | ԻՍ ԳԱՅՐԻՆԼ ՍԱՐԽԱԴԴԵԼՈՍ ՆԵՒԵ
ՓՐԱԿԻ ԱԳԻ ՊԱՐՈՉ ԵՆ ՕՍՏՐԱՄԱ ԿԱԴԱ ԺԵԼԵՅՑԻՍ ՆԵՒԵ ՍԱԿՈՒ
ՆԱԴԱԹՈՍ, ՍԵՃԱՉ ՆԱՉ ԴԵ ԿՈՏԻՓ ՍՈՒՐԻ ՆԱԴԱԿԻԼ, ՆՍԵՐԵՐ ԶՈՒ
ԵՊԵՍ ՄԱՐԻԱ ԴԵԿՏՐԻՄԻ ԵՐՈՔ: ՓԻ ԴԱՐ ԵԴԵՏՆԱՄԱՏՉ, ՕՍ ԵՅՈԼԵՆ
ՕՍՍՆԵՄԱ ԵՓՕԴԱՅ ՍԵ. ² ԵՏԵՄԻՍԻ ՆՕՍՈՒՐԻ, ԵԿԵՄՕՒԺ ԵՍԵՐԱՆ
ԴԵ ԻՏՕՍՑ: ՆԹՕՉ ԵԹ ՆԱԴՄՈՆԻ ՆՆԻԵԹՆՈՍ ԴԻՐՕՍ ԵՆ ՕՍՈՒՅՈՒ
ՄԵՆԻՍԻ. ³ ՕՍՐՁ Ա ՍԱԴԴԵԼՈՍ ՊԵ ՆԱՉ ԵՅՈԼ ԶԱՐՈՉ, ԱԳԴՈՒՉ ԴԵ
ՆԱԴԵ ԿՈՏԻՓ ԵՅՈԼԵՆ ՍԵՆԿՈՒ, ԱԿԻՐԻ ԿԱԴԱ ՓՐԻԺ ԵՒ Ա
ՍԱԴԴԵԼՈՍ ՆԵՒԵ ՍՏՕԻՍ ՕԴԱՐՏԱՐՆԻ ՆԱՉ, ԱԳՊԵՍ ՄԱՐԻԱ ԵՐՈՉ.

¹ But, in the middle of the night, behold Gabriel, the archangel
of joy, came to him in a vision, according to the command of my
good Father, and said to him, “Joseph, you son of David, fear
not, take Mary your wife to you; for, what she will bear is of the
Holy Spirit. ² She shall bear a Son; and you shall call his name
Jesus; it is he that will rule all the nations with a rod of iron.”
³ And the angel departed from him. And Joseph arose from his
sleep and did as the angel of the Lord commanded him; and he
took Mary to him.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 6

- ¹ The literal translation of ‘*the Holy Spirit*’ is ‘*a holy spirit*’.
² For ‘*rule*’, the *Bohairic MS* has ‘*feed*’.
³ Literally translated, ‘*his sleep*’ is ‘*the sleep*’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 7

¹ MENENCA NAI ΔΕ ΑΦΙ-ΕΒΟΛ ΝΧΕ ΟΥΔΟΓΜΑ ΖΙΤΕΝ ΑΥΓΟΥΣΤΟΣ ΠΟΥΡΟ ΕΘΡΕ ΤΟΙΚΟΥΜΕΝΗ ΤΗΡC Τ ΡΕΝC ΕΒΟΥΝ, ΠΙΟΥΑΙ ΠΙΟΥΙΑ ΝCΑ ΤΕΦΒΑΚΙ. ² ΑΥΤΩΝΥ ΖΩΥ ΝΧΕ ΦΑ ΤΜΕΤΒΕΛΛΟ ΕΘ ΝΑΝΕC, ΑΦΟΙ ΜΜΑΡΙΔ ΤΑΜΑΥ ΜΠΑΡΘΕΝΟC ΕΖΡΝΙ ΕΤΕΦΒΑΚΙ ΒΗΘΛΕΕΜ (ΧΕ ΑCΗΩΝΤ ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΜΙCΙ), Ε ΑΦCΗΑΙ ΜΠΕΦΡΑΝ ΖΑΤΕΝ ΠΙΓΡΑΜΜΑΤΕΥC ΧΕ ΚΟCΗΦ ΠΩΝΡΙ ΝΔΑΥΙΔ ΝΕΜ ΜΑΡΙΔ ΤΕΦCΖΙΜΙ ΝΕΜ ΙΝCΟΥC ΠΕΦΩΝΡΙ ΖΑΝ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΕ ΉΕΝ ΤΦΥΛΗ ΝΙΟΥΔΑ. ³ ΟΥΟZ Δ ΜΑΡΙΔ ΤΑΜΑΥ ΜΙCΙ ΜΜΟΙ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΜΩΙΤ ΝΤΑCΘΟ ΕΒΗΘΛΕΕΜ ΉΑΤΕΝ ΠΕΖΑΥ ΝΡΑΧΗΛ ΤCΖΙΜΙ ΝΙΑΚΩΒ ΠΠΑΤΡΙΑΡΧΗC, ΕΤΕ ΘΑΙ ΤΕ ΘΜΑΥ ΝΙΩCΗΦ ΝΕΜ ΒΕΝΙΑΜΙΝ.

¹ Now, after these things, there went out a decree from Augustus the king, that all the world should give in its name, each one after his city. ² The good old man also arose and took Mary my virgin mother up to his city Bethlehem; for, she was near to bearing a child. And he wrote his name through the scribe: Joseph, the son of David, and Mary his wife and Jesus his son are of the tribe of Judah. ³ And Mary my Mother bore me in the way that turns to Bethlehem, by the tomb of Rachel, the wife of Jacob the patriarch, who is the mother of Joseph and Benjamin.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 7

- ¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXVI*, ends, “that all the world should enrol itself after its villages” (ΕΤΡΕ ΤΟΙΚΟΥΜΕΝΗ ΤΗΡC ΕΖΑΙC ΝCΑ ΝΕCΤΜΕ).
² Robinson (in a footnote) offers ‘unto’ as an alternative for ‘up to’.
³ The literal translation of ‘the way that turns’ is ‘the way of turning’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 8

¹ ὁ σαδδανας ἐρ σύμβουλεῖν ἡρώδης πινίωτ, φιώτ ἡαρχηλαος, φη ἐτ ἀφώλι ἡταφε ἡπαμενριτ ογορ πασύνγενης ἰωαννης. ² παῖ ρητ ἀρκωτ ἡσὼι ἐπχινῷοθετ, ἐμμεγί χε ταμτογρο θα παῖ κοσμος τε. ³ ογορ ἀχχος ἡωσχηφ ἐβολ ζιτεν παιωτ ἡεν ογροραμα, ογορ ἀφτωνφ, ἀφσι ἡμοι νεμ μαρια ταμαγ, ειρεμσι ἐχεν νεσναγζ, ἐρε σαλομη μοωι νσων, ἀνωε ναν ἐρηι ἐχνηι, ἀνγεμοι ἡμαγ ἡογρομη ἡέροογ φατε πσωμα ἡηρώδης ἐρ φεντ, ἡτεφμογ εθε πσνοφ ἡνικογχι ἡάλωογι ἡαθνοβι ἐτ ἀφφονφ ἐβολ.

¹ Satan gave counsel to Herod the great, the father of Archelaus, who beheaded John, my beloved and my kinsman. ² Thus, he sought after me, to slay me, thinking that my kingdom was of this world. ³ And Joseph was told by my Father in a vision; and he arose and took me and Mary my mother – I sitting on her arms and Salome following us. We went down to Egypt, and dwelt there the space of a year of days, until Herod's body bred worms, so that he died, because of the blood of the sinless little children that he shed.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 8

- ¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXVI*, ends halfway through the name, 'Archelaus' (ἡαρχη[λαος]).
- ² The MS has 'is' in place of 'was', here following Robinson.
- ³ Robinson lacks 'of days', here following the MS.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 9

¹ ἮΝ ΠΑΡΙΝΘΡΕΥ ΜΟΥ ΔΕ ἮΔΕ ΠΑΠΑΡΑΝΟΜΟΣ ἘΤΕΜΜΑΥ ἩΡΟΔΗΣ
| ΑΝΤΑΣΘΟΝ ἘΠΚΑΖΙ ἩΠΙΣΡΑΗΛ, ΟΥΟΖ ΔΝΩΩΠΙ ἮΝ ΟΥΒΑΚΙ ἮΤΕ
†ΓΑΛΙΛΕΑ Ἐ ΠΕΣΡΑΝ ΠΕ ΝΑΖΑΡΕΘ. ² ΠΑΙΩΤ ΔΕ ΙΩΣΗΦ, ΠῖΕΛΛΟ
ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ, ΝΑΦΕΡ ΖΩΒ ΠΕ Ἐ†ΤΕΧΝΗ ἮΤΕ †ΜΕΤΖΑΜΩΕ,
ΕΝΟΝῃ ἘΠΖΩΒ ἮΤΕ ΝΕΦΧΙΧ, ἩΠΕΦΟΥΩΜ ἩΟΥΩΙΚ ἩΧΙΝΧΝ ἘΝΕΖ,
ΕΦΙΡΙ ΚΑΤΑ ΦΝΟΜΟΣ ἩΜΩΎCΗC.

¹ Now, when that lawless *man* Herod was dead, we returned to
the land of Israel, and we dwelt in a city of Galilee, whose name
is Nazareth. ² And my father Joseph, the blessed old man, was
working at the trade of carpentry, whilst we lived by the work
of his hands. He never ate bread for nought, doing according to
the law of Moses.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 9

¹ The MS lacks the word, '*man*', here following Robinson.

² Cf. 2Th 3:8.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 10

¹ ΟΥΟΖ ΜΕΝΕΝΣΑ ΠΑΙ ΝΙΩΤ ΝΣΟΥ ΉΠΕ ΠΕΨΩΜΑ ΕΡ ΑΤΧΟΜ, ΉΠΕ ΠΕΨΒΑΛ ΕΡ ΔΘΟΥΩΙΝΙ, ΉΠΕ ΟΥΝΑΧΖΙ ΝΟΥΩΤ ΩΩΩ ΉΕΝ ΡΩΩ, ΉΠΕΨΕΡ ΑΤΕΜΙ ΖΙ ΣΟΦΙΑ ΉΠΑΙ ΣΟΥ ΤΗΡΩ, ΑΛΛΑ ΝΑΨΟΙ ΉΦΡΗΤ ΝΟΥΑΛΟΥ ΠΕ, ΝΕ Δ ΠΕΨΑΖΙ ΩΩΠΙ ΩΑ ΡΙΑ ΉΡΟΜΠΙ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΜΕΤΉΕΛΛΟ Ε ΝΑΝΕΣ.

¹ And, after this long time, his body was not without power, nor were his eyes without light, nor was a single tooth in his mouth destroyed. He was not without understanding in wisdom all this time, but he was as a youth. And his life had come to one hundred and eleven years in a good old age.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 10

¹ Note that neither Lagarde nor Robinson include a verse number for this chapter, or others that have only a single verse.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 11

¹ περὶ δὲ ἡνιωτὶ ἡγῆρι ἰωσήτος καὶ συμῶν ἀγῶσι ἐζῆμι, ἀγῶ
νωοῦ ἐποῦνι, οὐοὺ τεφῶρι ἐνοῦτ ἀγῶσι ζαὶ ζωοῦ ἡφρητ
ἐτεσχη ἐβρῆνι ἡρῶνι νῖβεν: ἰωσήφ δὲ ἀρῆμεσι καὶ ἰακώβω
περὶκοῦχι ἡγῆρι. ² ἦεν πλῖνῶρε τῆ παρῶενος μισὶ ἡμοὶ ναιῶον
καὶ ζωοῦ πε. ἦεν ζῆποτακῆ νῖβεν ἡτε τῆ μετῶνρι, καὶ οὔνι γὰρ
αἰερ ζωβ νῖβεν ἡτε τῆ μετῶνρι | ὡατεν φῆοβι ἡμαγᾶτq. ³ ἀνοκ
καὶ ναιμοῦτ ἐμαρῖα καὶ ταμαγ οὐοὺ ἰωσήφ καὶ παῖωτ, οὐοὺ
ναιῶτεμ ἡνωοῦ ἦεν ζωβ νῖβεν ἐτ οὔναχοτοῦ νῆνι, ἡπιοῦσεμ
ἡοῦσαχι ἐβῶνι ἐχῶοῦ, ἀλλὰ ναιμεὶ ἡμῶοῦ πε ἐμαῶω.

¹ Now, his two elder sons Josetos and Simon took wives, and
went to their house; and his two daughters also took
husbands, as it is laid down for all men. But Joseph dwelt
with James his youngest son. ² When the Virgin bore me, I
was with them in all subjection of sonship; for, I did every
work of mankind, sin only excepted. ³ And I called Mary my
mother and Joseph my father; and I obeyed them in all things
that they told me. I did not answer a word to them, but I loved
them exceedingly.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 11

¹ Robinson here has 'Symeon' in place of 'Simon' but cf. 2:3.

² Cf. Lk 2:51.

³ For 'told', the MS has 'will tell'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 12

¹ ἀσώπῃ δὲ μένεσθαι, ἀφθόντ' ἐβοῦν ἵκε φμοῦ ἡώσῃφ
παιώτ κατα φρητ' ἐτ' ὅνῳ ἡρώμῃ ἡβεν. ² ἦεν πλινῶρε
πεφωμά ὡνῃ ἂ πεφάγγελος ταμοῦ χε ἡβρῆ ἦεν ται ρομπ
χναμοῦ. ³ οὔορ ἦεν πλινῶρε τεφύχῃ φθορτερ ἀφῶε ναῦ
ἐρρῆ ἐίεροῦσαλῆμ, ἀφῶ ναῦ ἐβοῦν ἐπερφεῖ ἡτε πσοῖς, ἀφτ'
μετανοιά ρι τῇ ἡπιόχιαστηρίον, ἀφτῶβρ ἡπαῖ ρητ' ἐφῶ
ἡμος χε

¹ Now, it came to pass after these things that the death of
Joseph my father drew nigh, even as it is appointed for all
men. ² When his body was sick, his angel told him, "In this
year shall you die." ³ And, when his soul was troubled, he
went up to Jerusalem, and he went into the temple of the
Lord, and he repented before the altar, and prayed thus,
saying,

DEATH OF JOSEPH 12

¹ Cf. Heb 9:27.

² The exact nuance of the phrase, '*his angel*', is uncertain.

³ The literal translation of '*repented*' is '*gave repentance*'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 13

¹ φΝΟΥΤ ΦΙΩΤ ΝΤΕ ΜΕΤΩΝΕΖΗΤ ΝΙΒΕΝ ΟΥΟΖ ΦΝΟΥΤ ΝΤΕ ΣΑΡΖ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΠΣΟΙΣ ΝΤΑΨΧΗ ΝΕΜ ΠΑΣΩΜΑ ΝΑΜ ΠΑΠΝΕΥΜΑ: ² ΙΣΧΕ ΝΙΕΖΟΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΑΩΝΉ ΕΤ ΑΚΤΗΙΤΟΥ ΝΖΙ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ, ΑΥΧΩΚ-ΕΒΟΛ, ΙΕ ΤΤ ΖΟ ΕΡΟΚ, ΠΣΟΙΣ ΦΝΟΥΤ, ΕΘΡΕΚ ΟΥΩΡΠ ΝΗΙ ΝΜΙΧΑΗΛ ΠΑΡΧΗΑΓΓΕΛΟΣ, ΝΤΕΦ|ΟΡΙ ΕΡΑΤΨ ΝΕΜΗΙ, ΨΑΤΕ ΤΑΨΧΗ ΝΕΒΗΝ Ι ΕΒΟΛΉΕΝ ΠΑΣΩΜΑ ΑΤΩΝΕ ΉΙΣΙ ΝΕΜ ΨΘΟΡΤΕΡ: ³ ΧΕ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΖΟΤ ΝΕΜ ΝΚΑΖ ΠΕ ΦΜΟΥ ΝΡΩΜΙ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΙΤΕ ΡΩΜΙ ΙΤΕ ΤΕΒΝΗ ΙΤΕ ΘΗΡΙΟΝ ΙΤΕ ΣΑΤΨΙ ΙΤΕ ΖΑΛΗΤΛ ⁴ ΑΠΛΩ ΣΩΝΤ ΝΙΒΕΝ ΕΤ ΣΑ ΠΕΣΝΤ ΝΤΦΕ, ΕΤΕ ΟΥΟΝ ΨΧΗ ΝΩΝΉ ΝΉΗΤΨ, ΟΥΉΙΣ ΠΕ ΝΕΜ ΟΥΜΚΑΖ, ΨΑΤΕ ΤΟΥΨΧΗ ΦΩΡΧ ΕΠΟΥΣΩΜΑ. ⁵ ΤΝΟΥ ΧΕ, Ω ΠΑΣΟΙΣ, ΜΑΡΕ ΠΕΚΑΓΓΕΛΟΣ ΟΡΙ ΕΡΑΤΨ ΝΕΜ ΤΕΨΧΗ ΝΕΜ ΠΑΣΩΜΑ, ΨΑΤΟΥΦΩΡΧ-ΕΒΟΛ ΝΝΟΥΕΡΗΟΥ ΑΤΩΝΕ ΉΙΣΙ. ⁶ ΝΝΕΚΘΕΡΕ ΠΑΓΓΕΛΟΣ ΕΤ ΘΗΨ ΕΡΟΙ ΙΣΧΕ ΠΙΕΖΟΟΥ ΕΤ ΑΖΕΡ ΠΛΑΖΙΝ ΝΜΟΙ ΨΑ ΕΨΟΥΝ ΕΤΝΟΥ, ΜΟΖ ΝΠΕΨΖΟ ΝΧΩΝΤ ΕΨΟΥΝ ΕΡΟΙ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΜΩΙΤ ΝΜΩΨΙ ΕΙΝΗΟΥ ΖΑΡΟΚ, ΑΛΛΑ ΜΑΡΕΨΕΡ ΖΙΡΗΝΗ ΝΕΜΗΙ. ⁷ ΝΠΕΝΘΕΡΕ ΝΗ ΕΤΕ ΠΟΥΖΟ ΨΕΒ*ΙΗΟΥΤ, Τ ΉΙΣΙ ΝΗΙ ΖΕΝ ΠΙΜΩΙΤ ΝΜΩΨΙ ΕΙΝΗΟΥ ΖΑΡΟΚ. ⁸ ΝΠΕΝΘΕΡΕ ΝΗ ΕΤ ΖΙΧΕΝ ΝΙΨΥΛΗ,

¹ "God, the Father of all mercies and the God of all flesh, the Lord of my soul and of my body and of my spirit: ² if the days of my life that you have given me in the world, are ended, I beseech you, Lord God, that you would send me Michael the archangel, to stand by me, until my wretched soul goes forth from my body without trouble and confusion. ³ For, a great fear and grief is death to all men, whether *it be* man or cattle or wild beast or creeping thing or bird. ⁴ In short, every creature that is under heaven, in which is *a* soul of life, there is trouble and grief *to them*, until their soul is separated from their body. ⁵ Now therefore, O my Lord, let your angel stand by my soul and my body, until they are separated from one another without trouble. ⁶ Cause not the angel, appointed to me from the day that you formed me until now, to burn in his face with anger towards me in the path, as I come to you; but let him be at peace with me. ⁷ Let not those whose face is diverse trouble me in the path, as I come to you. ⁸ Let not those who *are* by the gates

DEATH OF JOSEPH 13

- ¹ The word here translated 'mercies' could also be read as a singular noun.
- ² Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns that refer to God.
- ³ The MS lacks the words, 'it be', here following Robinson.
- ⁴ The MS lacks the words, 'to them', here following Robinson.
- ⁵ This section reflects the tradition that every man has a guardian angel.
- ⁶ The Sahidic fragment, B.M. Or. 3581, begins halfway through this verse.
- ⁷ It is not clear what is meant by 'who face is diverse'.
- ⁸ Another reading for 'by the gates' is 'on the gates'.

ερ καχεχιν ἡταψχην, οὐδε ἡπερτ ὡπι νηι ἥεν πεκβημα | ετ
οι ἡζοτ. ⁹ ἡπενθορυ ερ θηριον ἔβογν ἔροι ἡχε νιζωμι ἡτε
πιαρο ἡχρωμ, φαι ἔτε ὡαρε ψχην ἡτε τεκμεθνογτ. ¹⁰ ὦ
φνογτ ετ ραπ ἔπιογαι πιογαι ἥεν ογμεθῆνι nem
ογδικεόσγνη, τῆνογ χε, παβοις, μαρε πεκναι ὡπι νηι
ἡκολσελ, χε ἡθοκ πε τῆμογμι ἡτε ἀγαθον νιβεν: πῶογ φωκ
πε ὡα ἔνεζ ἡτε νιῆνεζ. ἀμην.

restrain my soul; neither put me to shame at your fearful
judgment seat. ⁹ Let not the waves of the river of fire be savage
towards me, wherein all souls are purified, before they see the
glory of your godhead, ¹⁰ O God who judges each one in truth
and righteousness. Now, therefore, my Lord, let your mercy be
to me a consolation; for, you are the Fountain of all good. Yours
is the glory to the ages of the ages. Amen."

⁹ For this verse, the Sahidic fragment, *B.M. Or.3581*, reads, "Let me not be shamefully entreated, neither let the threatening waves of demons be savage towards me, wherein all souls will be purged, before they see the glory of your godhead."

¹⁰ The Sahidic fragment, *B.M. Or.3581*, is damaged at this point and parts of the verse are illegible.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 14

¹ ἄσσωπι δε μενεσκα ναι, ἀφὶ ἐξρηι ἐάζαρεθ ተβακὶ
ἐτεφωοπ ἡντς, ἀφενκοτ ἥεν πκωνι ετεφναμογ ἡντς
ἡφρητ ἐτ ἠω ἡρωμι νιβεν. ² ογος νारे πεφωωνι ἡορω
ἐμαωω πε παρα νισοπ τηρογ ἐ φαφωωνι ιςχεν πέρσοογ ἐτ
αγχφογ ἐπκωσμος. ³ θα τε ταμαστροφη μπαμενριτ ἡωτ
ιωσφ. ⁴ ἀφερ ̅̅ ἡρομπι, ἀφει σζιμι, ογος κε ̅̅ ἡρομπι
εφζεμσι ἥεν πιγamos nem τεφςζιμι, ογος αςμογ: ἀφερ
ογρομπι ἡμαγatz. ⁵ ἂ ταμαγ ἐρ κε σνογτ ἡρομπι ἥεν
πεφνι ἥεν πχινθορογ τηις | ναφ ἡδε νιογνβ, ἐ αγταμογ
ἐβολ ζιτεν νιογνβ δε ἀρεζ ἐρος φα πχογ ἡερ πζοπ
ἐρωτεν. ⁶ ἥεν ταρχη ἡτμαζγτ ἡρομπι εςχη ἥεν πεφνι (ἐτε
τμαζγτ ἡρομπι ἡτε πεσωκς τε), ἀδμισι ἡμοι ζιχεν πκαζι
ἥεν ογμγστηριον, ἡμον ζλι σωογν ἡμογ ἥεν πικωντ τηρς
ἐβηλ ἐροι nem παιωτ nam πινπεγμα εθ ογab, ἐνωοπ ἥεν
ογμετογαι.

¹ Now, it came to pass after these things, he went to Nazareth, the
city in which he dwelt. And he lay down with the sickness with
which he should die, even as it is appointed for all men. ² And his
sickness was very heavy, beyond all the times that he was sick,
from the day that he was born into the world. ³ This is the manner
of life of my beloved father Joseph. ⁴ He was forty years *old when*
he took a wife and other forty-nine years living in wedlock with
his wife. And she died; and he was a year alone. ⁵ My mother was
two other years in his house, when the priests gave her to him,
when he was told by the priests, *saying*, "Keep her until the time
of your marriage." ⁶ At the beginning of the third year, whilst she
was in his house, which is the fifteenth year of her life, she bore
me on the earth in a mystery; no one knows it in the whole
creation, save me and my Father and the Holy Spirit, being as we
are in unity.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 14

- ¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, begins at this verse and continues up to 24:1.
- ² The 2 Sahidic fragments read slightly differently: "And his sickness was very heavy, more than all the times that he was sick, since he was born into the world."
- ³ The Sahidic fragment, *B.M. Or. 3581*, lacks 'beloved'.
- ⁴ The 2 Sahidic fragments have 'forty' in place of 'forty-nine'.
- ⁵ Literally translated, the verse ends, "the time of making the marriage feast for you."
- ⁶ The Sahidic fragment, *B.M. Or. 3581*, lacks 'being as we are in unity'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 15

¹ ΝΙΕΖΟΥ ΔΕ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΩΚῃ ἸΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΦ ΠῃΕΛΛΟ ΕΤ
CMAPOYΤ PIA ἸΡΟΜΠ ΝΕ ΚΑΤΑ ΦΡΗΤ ΕΤ ΑΦΟΥΑΖCΑΖΝΙ ἸΧΕ
ΠΑΙΩΤ ΝΑΓΑΘΟC. ² ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΔΕ ΕΤ ΑΦΙ ΕΒΟΛῃΕΝ CΩΜΑ ἸῃΗΤῃ,
ΠΕ CΟΥΚῤ ἸΠΙΑΒΟΤ ΕΠΗΠ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ ΑΦΡΙ ΑΡΧΗ ἸΩΙΒΤ ἸΧΕ ΠΙΝΟΥΒ
ΕΤ CΟΤΠ, ΕΤΕ ΤCΑΡΖ ΤΕ ἸΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΦ, ΟΥΟΖ Ἀ ΝΙΖΑΤ ΦΩΝΖ,
ΕΤΕ ΠΙΝΟC ΠΕ ΝΕΜ ΤCΟΦΙΑ. ⁴ ΑΦΕΡ ΠΩΝΩ ἸΠΙΟΥΩΜ ΝΕΜ ΠΙCΩ
Ἀ ΤCΟΦΙΑ ἸΤΕ ΤΜΕΤΤΕΧΝΙΤΗC ΚΟΤC ΕΥCΟΡΜΕC. ⁵ ΑΔΩΠΙ ΔΕ
ῃΕΝ ΠΧΙΝΟΡΕ ΠΙΟΥΩΙΝΙ ΩΑΙ ἸΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΕΤΕΜΜΑΥ, ΕΤΕ CΟΥΚῤ ΠΕ
ἸΠΙΑΒΟΤ ΕΠΗΠ, Ἀ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΦ ΩΘΟΡΤΕΡ ΕῃΜΑΩΩ ΕΧΕΝ
ΠΕΦΜΑΝΕΝΚΟΤ, ΑΦΕΩ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ἸΦΙ-ΔΖΟΜ, ΑΦΚΩΛΖ ἸΝΕΦΧΙΧ
ΕΧΕΝ ΝΟΥΕΡΗΝΟΥ, ΑΦΩΩ-ΕΒΟΛ ῃΕΝ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ἸΩΘΟΡΤΕΡ ΕΦΧΩ
ἸΜΟC ἸΠΑΙ ΡΗΤ ΧΕ

¹ Now, all the days of the life of my father Joseph, the blessed
old man, are a hundred and eleven years, even as my good
Father commanded. ² And the day wherein he went forth from
the body is the twenty sixth of the month Epep. ³ And the choice
gold, even the flesh of my father Joseph, began to be altered; and
the silver was changed, even the mind and the wisdom. ⁴ He
forgot to eat and to drink; the wisdom of the craft turned into
error. ⁵ And it came to pass, when the light arose on that day,
which is the twenty-sixth of the month Epep, my father Joseph
was much troubled on his bed; and he uttered a great groan,
and smote his hands together, and cried out in great trouble,
speaking thus:

DEATH OF JOSEPH 15

- ¹ The 2 Sahidic fragments end the verse, “*according to the command of my Father.*”
- ² The Sahidic fragment, *B.M. Or. 3581*, ends just after the start of this verse, which therein reads, “*And, in the sickness of his death ...*”
- ³ This verse is rather shorter in Sahidic fragment *Borgianus CXXI*: “*The silver was changed, even the mind and the wisdom.*”
- ⁴ Literally translated, the verse opens, “*He forgot the eating and drinking.*”
- ⁵ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, lacks ‘*which is the twenty-sixth of the month Epep*’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 16

¹ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΗΙ ΜΦΟΟΥ, ΟΥΟΙ ΜΠΕΞΟΥ ΕΤ Α ΤΑΜΑΥ ΧΦΟΙ
ΕΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ. ² ΟΥΟΙ ΝΤΟΤ ΕΤ ΑΙΧΙ ΧΡΟΧ ΝΩΝΗ ΝΗΗΤΣ, ΟΥΟΙ
ΝΝΙΕΜΝΟΤ ΕΤ ΑΙΣΙ ΕΡΩΤ ΝΗΗΤΟΥ. ³ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΝΙΣΑΛΑΥΧ ΕΤ
ΑΙΖΕΜΣΙ ΖΙ ΧΩΟΥ. ⁴ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΝΙΧΙΧ ΕΤ ΑΥΤΩΟΥΝΟΥ ΝΜΟΙ ΤΑΤΕΡ
ΝΙΩΤ, ΝΤΑΩΩΠΙ ΉΕΝ ΦΝΟΒΙ. ⁵ ΟΥΟΙ ΜΠΑΛΑΣ ΝΕΜ ΝΑΦΟΤΟΥ,
ΧΕ ΑΥΣΛΟΜΛΕΜ ΝΟΥΜΗΩ ΝΣΟΠ ΉΕΝ ΠΙΣΙΝΧΟΝΣ ΝΕΜ
ΤΚΑΤΑΛΑΛΙΑ ΝΕΜ ΠΙΖΙ-ΛΑ ΝΝΟΥΧ ΝΕΜ ΝΙΣΑΧΙ ΝΑΡΚΟΝ ΝΣΙ-ΖΡΑΦ
ΕΘ ΜΕΖ ΝΑΠΑΤΗ. ⁶ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΝΑΒΑΛ, ΧΕ ΑΥΣΟΜΣ ΕΖΑΝΣΚΑΝΔΑΛΟΝ.
⁷ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΝΑΜΑΩΧ, ΧΡΕ ΑΥΜΕΝΡΕ ΣΩΤΕΜ ΕΝΙΣΑΧΙ ΝΕΦΛΗΟΥ.
⁸ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΝΑΧΙ, ΧΕ ΑΥΩΛΙ ΝΝΗ ΕΤΕ ΝΟΥΟΥ ΑΝ ΝΕ. ⁹ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΤΑΝΕΧΙ
ΝΕΜ ΝΑΜΑΪΤ, ΧΕ ΑΥΕΡ ΕΠΙΘΥΜΙΝ ΕΖΑΝΧΙΝΟΥΩΜ ΕΤΕ ΝΟΥΟΥ ΑΝ
ΝΕ. ΘΑΙ ΔΕ ΑΣΩΑΝ ΧΕΜ ΝΧΑΙ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΤΑC|ΡΟΚΖΟΥ ΕΖΟΤΕ ΟΥΖΡΩ
ΝΧΡΟΜ ΕΘ ΜΟΖ, ΤΑCΑΙΤΟΥ ΝΑΤΩΑΥ CΑ CΑ ΝΙΒΕΝ. ¹⁰ ΟΥΟΙ
ΝΝΑΣΑΛΑΥΧ, ΝΑΙ ΕΤ ΖΙΠΟΥΡΚΙΝ ΕΠΑΣΩΜΑ ΝΚΑΚΩC, ΕΥΩΛΙ
ΝΜΟΦ ΕΖΑΝΗΩΙΤ Ε ΝΑΝΕΥ ΑΝ. ¹¹ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΠΑΣΩΜΑ, ΧΕ ΑΦΕΡ

¹ "Woe to me today! Woe to the day that my mother brought
me forth into the world. ² Woe to the womb in which I
received seed of life. Woe to the breasts that I sucked. ³ Woe to
the knees on which I sat. ⁴ Woe to the hands that carried
me, until I grew up and became sinful. ⁵ Woe to my tongue
and my lips; for, they have been entangled often in violence
and in backbiting and in false slander and in idle words of
jest, full of deceit. ⁶ Woe to my eyes; for, they have looked
upon stumbling-blocks. ⁷ Woe to my ears; for, they have
loved to hear vain words. ⁸ Woe to my hands; for, they have
taken things that are not theirs. ⁹ Woe to my stomach and
my bowels; for, they have desired foods that are not theirs; and,
if it found anything, it would consume it more than a burning
fiery furnace and make it everywhere unprofitable. ¹⁰ Woe to
my feet, which served my body ill, taking it into no good ways.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 16

- ¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, lacks 'into the world' (ἐπικοςμος).
- ² *Borgianus CXXI* has only the 2nd sentence.
- ³ The Bohairic and Sahidic texts have the same text for this verse.
- ⁴ Literally translated, the verse ends, "grew up in sin."
- ⁵ *Borgianus CXXI* ends, "in all words of wantonness."
- ⁶ *Borgianus CXXI* adds 'and they have loved witchery' at the end of the verse.
- ⁷ *Borgianus CXXI* reads, "Woe to my ears, for they have loved the words of whisperings and all the words of swearing."
- ⁸ *Borgianus CXXI* has 'stolen' in place of 'taken'.
- ⁹ The literal translation of 'consume it' is 'consume them'.
- ¹⁰ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, lacks vv. 10-11.

ταΰτην ἡψατο οὐδὲ ἡψενμο ἐφ'νοῦτ' ἐτ' ἀσθαιμος.
¹² αἰναερ οὐ τ'νοῦ; αἰωρ-ἐβοῦν σα σα νιβεν. ¹³ ἀληθως οὔτοι
ἡρωμε νιβεν ἐθ' ναερ νοβι. ¹⁴ ἀληθως φαι πε πινιωτ'
ἡωθορτερ ἐτ' αἰναγ' ἐρογ' ἐχεν ἰακωβ παιωτ' ἐφ'νοῦ
ἐβαλῃεν σωμα: ἡθογ' οἱ πε ἐτ' ἀσταροι ἡφοογ' ἡα πινωτ'.
¹⁵ ἀλλα ἰνς, φ'νοῦτ', φ'μεσιτης ἡταΰτην νεν πασωμα ἐτ' ἰρι
ἡπεφογωῶ ἡβρη ἡβητ'.

¹¹ Woe to my body; for, it has made my soul waste and strange
to God who made it. ¹² What shall I do now? I am shut in on
every side. ¹³ Truly woe to every man who shall sin. ¹⁴ Truly this
is the great trouble, which I saw on Jacob my father, when he
came forth from *the* body; it also has overtaken me the wretched
one today. ¹⁵ But Jesus, God, the mediator of my soul and of my
body, does his will in me."

¹¹ See #10.

¹² The Bohairic and Sahidic texts have the same text for this verse.

¹³ *Borgianus CXXI* repeats 'woe' (οὔτοι).

¹⁴ The MS does not have the definite article before 'body', here following Robinson.

¹⁵ *Borgianus CXXI* opens, "But the Lord my God."

DEATH OF JOSEPH 17

¹ ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΕΓΧΩ ΜΜΩΟΥ ΝΧΕ ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΗΦ, ΑΙΤΩΝΤ, ΑΙΜΩΙ ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΡΟΦ ΕΦΕΝΚΟΤ, ΑΙΧΕΜΦ ΕΦΩΘΕΡΤΩΡ ΉΕΝ ΤΕΦΥΧΗ ΝΕΜ ΠΕΦΠΝΕΥΜΑ, ΠΕΧΗΙ ΝΑΦ ΧΕ ΧΕΡΕ, ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΙΩΤ ΙΩΣΕΦ, ΦΑ ΤΜΕΤΉΕΛΛΟ ΕΘ ΝΑΝΕΣ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΥ ΕΥΣΟΠ. ² ΑΦΕΡ ΟΥΩ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΖΟΤ ΝΤΕ ΦΜΟΥ ΕΓΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΝΗΙ | ΧΕ ΧΕΡΕ ΝΟΥΜΗΩ ΝΟΟΠ, ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΩΗΡΙ: ΖΗΠΠΕ Α ΤΕΨΥΧΗ ΜΤΟΝ ΕΡΟΙ ΝΟΥΚΟΥΧΙ, ΕΤ ΑΙΩΤΕΜ ΕΤΕΚΣΗΝ. ³ ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΑΣΟΙΣ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΑΟΥΡΟ ΜΜΗΙ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΑΣΩΤΗΡ ΝΑΝΓΑΘΟΣ ΟΥΟΖ ΝΝΑΗΤ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΙΡΕΦΤΟΥΧΟ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΙΡΕΦΕΡΖΕΜΙ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΙΣΚΕΠΑΣΤΗΣ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΙ-Ε-ΤΗΡΦ ΉΕΝ ΡΩΦ ΝΟΥΟΝ ΝΙΒΕΝ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΦΚΕΝΙΩΟΥΤ ΕΜΑΩΩ, ΙΗΣΟΥΣ ΠΙΒΑΛ ΝΡΕΦΝΑΥ, ΠΙΜΑΩΧ ΝΡΕΦΣΩΤΕΜ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΜΕΘΜΗΙ, ΣΩΤΕΜ ΕΡΟΙ ΜΦΟΟΥ, ΑΝΟΚ ΉΑ ΠΕΦΒΩΚ ΕΙΤ ΖΟ ΕΡΟΚ, ΕΙΦΩΝ ΝΝΑΕΡΜΩΟΥΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΜΠΕΚΜΘΟ. ⁴ ΝΘΟΚ ΠΕ ΦΝΟΥΤ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΜΕΘΜΗΙ, ΝΘΟΚ ΝΕ ΠΣΟΙΣ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΜΕΘΜΗΙ, ΚΑΤΑ ΦΡΗΤ ΕΤ Α ΠΙΑΓΓΕΛΟΣ ΧΟΣ ΝΗΙ ΝΟΥΜΗΩ ΝΣΟΠ, ΜΑΛΙΣΤΑ ΠΙΕΖΟΟΥ ΕΤ Α ΠΑΖΗΤ ΣΙ ΣΑΝΙΣ ΕΡΟΙ ΕΘΒΕ ΟΥΜΕΥΙ ΜΜΕΤΡΟΜΙ ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΘΗ ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ ΜΠΑΡΘΕΝΟΣ ΧΕ ΑΣΕΡ ΒΟΚΙ ΕΙΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΧΕ ΤΝΑΖΙΤΣ ΕΒΟΛ ΝΧΩΠ. ⁵ ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΕΙΜΕΥΙ ΕΡΩΟΥ, Α ΠΙΑΓΓΕΛΟΣ ΟΥΩΝΖ ΝΗΙ ΕΒΟΛ ΉΕΝ ΟΥ|ΖΟΡΑΜΑ ΕΓΧΩ ΜΜΟΣ ΝΗΙ

¹ Now, as my beloved father Joseph was saying these things, I arose and went in to him as he lay down; and I found him troubled in his soul and his spirit. I said to him, "Hail, my beloved father Joseph, whose old age is at once good and blessed." ² He answered in great fear of death, saying to me, "Hail many times, my beloved Son. Behold my soul rested within me a little, when I heard your voice." ³ Jesus my Lord, Jesus my true King, Jesus my good and merciful Saviour, Jesus the Preserver, Jesus the Pilot, Jesus the Shelter, Jesus [who holds fast] the universe in your goodness, Jesus whose name is sweet in the mouth of all and very rich, Jesus the Eye that sees, the Ear that hears in truth, hear me today, even me your servant, as I beseech you, pouring out my tears before you. ⁴ You are God in truth, you are the Lord in truth, even as the angel said to me many times; especially *on* the day that my heart doubted within me, because of a human thought against her, blessed *and* virgin, because she was pregnant; when I said, I will put her away privately. ⁵ But, as I thought on these things, the angel appeared to me in a vision, saying to me, 'Joseph, you son of David, fear

DEATH OF JOSEPH 17

¹ Literally translated, the verse ends, "he of the old age, good and blessed at once."

² For 'within' the Bohairic MS has 'to'.

³ The words in brackets (following Robinson) are not in the Bohairic MS.

⁴ The Sahidic fragment, Borgianus CXXI reads: *For, you are God in truth and in perfection, even as your angel warned me many times; and especially on the day that my heart was grieved within me, because of a human thought concerning the blessed one, even Mary the Virgin. I troubled myself because she was with child, and I was saying, 'In this night I will put her away privately.'*

⁵ The literal translation of 'the Holy Spirit' is 'a holy spirit'.

χε ιωσηφ πωρηι ἡδαια, ἡπερερ ροτ ἐωρεπ μαρια τεκσζιμι
 ἐροκ: φη γαρ ετεснаμαсq, ογ ἐβολῃεν ογпνευμα εφογав.
⁶ ἡπερερ αμφιβαλλιν ἐπτηρϣ ἐχεν πεсχινервоки: сnamici
 γαρ ἡογωρηι εκέμογτ ἐπεφραν χε ιηсοус. ⁷ нөөк пе ιηсοус
 пхристос, псωτηр ἡταγχη nem παсωма nem παпneυμα,
 ἡπερχем ἀρικι ἐροι ἀнок ἡα πεквωк ογορ πρωв ἡτε некχι.
⁸ ἡπιέμι, ὦ παсoиc, ογδε ἡтсωογн an ἡпimγστηριон ἡτε
 πεкχинmici ἡπαρaдозoн, ογδε ἡпicωтем ἐнез χε ἀ ογсζиmи
 ep वोки асne сωoγт. ιсχε ἀ ογπαρθенос mici, естов ἡен
 теспарθениа. ⁹ ὦ παсoиc, ἐне пөωω ἡпai мγστηριон an пе,
 ἡ тнанарт an ἐрок пе nem πεкχинmici еθ ογав, ἡтат ὦογ
 ἡөн ет асmici ἡмок, ἐте θαι те маria тпарθенос еθ ογав.
¹⁰ тпρι ἡфmeγи on ἡπιέροоγ ет ἀ пикерастнс би лапci
 ἡпiαлао, аqмоγ. ¹¹ ἀ neφpωmи нωт ἐрок, χε εγнaтнiк
 ἡἡpωaнc. ¹² ἀ текметнант тазоq: актоγнocq, | ἡмоq,
 ογορ ογнioт ἡpαωи аqωωпи ἡен пнi ἡфн ет аqмоγ. ¹³ ἡен
 тoγнoγ aиaмoni ἡпекмаωχ, аicαχι nemал ειχω ἡмоc χε
 ἀpi cαвe, пөωpи. ¹⁴ ἡен тoγнoγ акер ἐпitиman ннi екχω

not, take Mary your wife to you; for, that which she will bear is
 of the Holy Spirit. ⁶ Have no doubt about her pregnancy; for,
 she will bear a Son; and you shall call his name Jesus.' ⁷ You are
 Jesus Christ, the Saviour of my soul and of my body and of my
 spirit. Do not blame me, your servant and the work of your
 hands. ⁸ I did not know, O my Lord, neither do I understand the
 mystery of your strange birth; neither did I ever hear that a
 woman was pregnant without a man, or that a virgin bore,
 sealed in her virginity. ⁹ O my Lord, if this is not the ordinance
 of this mystery, I will not believe in you and in your holy birth,
 and glorify her who bore you, Mary the holy Virgin. ¹⁰ I also
 remember the day the horned serpent bit the boy, and he died.
¹¹ His relations surrounded you, to might deliver you to Herod.
¹² Your mercy laid hold of him; and you raised him, concerning
 whom they slandered you, saying that you killed him. And there
 was great joy in the house of him that died. ¹³ Straight away, I
 took hold of your ear, and spoke with you, saying, 'Be prudent,
 my Son.' ¹⁴ Straight away, you rebuked me, saying, 'Unless you

⁶ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI* opens, 'neither hesitate concerning her conception'.

⁷ At the end of the verse, *Borgianus CXXI* adds, "Did not I trouble myself, O my Lord?"

⁸ *Borgianus CXXI* reads: But I do not yet understand the glory of this great mystery, which is your holy birth, neither again did I ever hear that a woman was with child without a man.

⁹ For 'Mary the holy Virgin', *Borgianus CXXI* has 'Mary the true lamb'.

¹⁰ After 'bit the boy', *Borgianus CXXI* adds 'on his foot'.

¹¹ The literal translation of 'relations' is 'men'.

¹² The MS does not have the word, 'saying', here following Robinson.

¹³ *Borgianus CXXI* reads: But I requested you, O my beloved Son, saying, 'Be quiet in all things.' And I took hold of your right ear and pulled it.

¹⁴ The literal translation of 'surely' (following Robinson) is 'it not being so'.

ἦμος ἔβηλ ἔε ἡθούκ πε παῖωτ κατὰ σαρκί, ἡμον
ναῖναταμοκ πε ἔε οὐ πε φαί ετ ἀκαίῃ νηι. ¹⁵ ἡνοῦ ἔε, ὦ
παβοῖς οὐορ πανοῦτ, ἐῶωπ ετ ἀκί ωπ νημη εῶβε πῆροοῦ
ἐτεμμαγ, ἀκῶρε ναι μῆνι ἡροτ ἰ ἐρῆνι ἐχῶι, ἡτ ῥο
ἐτεκμετάγαθος, ἡτεκωτεμεντ ἐῶοῦν ἐβι ῥαπ νημη.
¹⁶ ἡνοκ πε πεκβωκ νημ πωῆρ ἡτε τεκβωκί. ¹⁷ ἀκωαν σῶλπ
ἡναςναγῥ, ἡναῶωτ ναι ἡοῦῶοῦῶοῦῶι ἡσμοῦ ἐτε θαί τε
ἡόμολογία ἡτε πῶοῦ ἡτε τεκμεῶνοῦτ, ἔε ἡθούκ πε ἡσῶς
πῡριστος πῶῥι ἡφῆνοῦτ ἡεν οῦμεῶμῆνι οὐορ πῶῆρ ἡφῆρῶνι
ἐῡσῶπ.

were my father according to the flesh, surely I would have told
you what this thing is that you have done to me.’ ¹⁵ Now,
therefore, O my Lord and my God, if you have reckoned with
me for that day, and have caused these fearful signs to come on
me, I beseech your goodness not to bring me in, to contend with
me. ¹⁶ I am your servant and the son of your handmaid. ¹⁷ If you
break my bonds asunder, I will sacrifice to you a sacrifice of
praise, even the confession of the glory of your godhead, that
you are Jesus Christ, at once the Son of God in truth and the Son
of man.”

¹⁵ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, reads: *And now, O my beloved Son, my Lord and my God, if you have taken account with me for that day, and have caused these fearful signs to come on me, I beseech you, O my good Lord, forgive me and reckon not with me.*

¹⁶ At the start of the verse, *Borgianus CXXI* adds ‘For’ (ῥαπ).

¹⁷ Another reading for ‘that’ is ‘for’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 18

¹ ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΕΓΧΩ ΜΟΟΥ ΝΧΕ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΧΦ, ΜΠΙΜΟΝΙ ΔΩΝΕ † ΕΡΗΝ, ΟΥΟΖ ΔΙΡΙΜΙ ΕΙΧΟΥΩΤ ΕΡΟΦ ΧΕ Δ ΦΜΟΥ | ΕΡ ΣΟΙΣ ΕΡΟΦ, ΟΥΟΖ ΕΙΩΤΕΜ ΕΝΙΣΑΧΙ ΜΜΕΤΤΑΛΕΠΩΡΟΣ ΕΤΕΓΧΩ ΜΜΩΟΥ.
² ΟΥΟΖ ΜΕΝΕΝΣΑ ΝΑΙ, Ω ΝΑΣΝΗΟΥ, ΔΡΙ ΦΜΕΥΙ ΜΠΑΜΟΥ ΕΧΕΝ ΠΙΣΤΑΥΡΟΣ ΕΧΕΝ ΠΩΝΗ ΜΠΙΚΟΣΜΟΣ ΤΗΡΦ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ ΑΣΤΩΝΣ ΝΧΕ ΤΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΜΜΑΥ ΜΑΡΙΔ ΘΑ ΠΙΡΑΝ ΕΘ ΝΟΤΕΜ ΉΕΝ ΡΩΦ ΝΟΥΟΝ ΝΙΒΕΝ ΕΘ ΜΕΙ ΜΜΟΙ, ΠΕΧΑΣ ΝΗΙ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΜΚΑΖ ΝΖΗΤ ΧΕ ΟΥΟΙ ΝΗΙ, ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΩΗΡΙ, ΔΡΗΟΥ ΕΦΝΑΜΟΥ ΝΧΕ ΦΑ †ΜΕΤΉΕΛΛΟ ΕΘ ΝΑΝΕΣ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ ΙΩΧΦ, ΠΕΚΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΙΩΤ ΕΤ ΤΑΙΗΟΥΤ ΚΑΤΑ ΣΑΡΖ. ⁴ ΠΕΧΗΙ ΝΑΣΛ Ω ΤΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΜΜΑΥ, ΝΙΜ ΕΝΕΖ ΉΕΝ ΝΙΡΩΜΙ ΕΤ ΑΦΕΡ ΦΟΡΙΝ ΝΟΥΣΑΡΖ ΕΤΕ 'ΝΟΥΑΧΕΜ †ΠΙ ΜΦΜΟΥ ΑΝ; ⁵ ΦΜΟΥ ΓΑΡ ΠΕ ΠΑΡΧΩΝ Ν†ΜΕΤΡΩΜΙ, Ω ΤΑΜΑΥ ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ: ⁶ ΖΩ† ΓΑΡ ΕΡΟ ΖΩ ΠΕ ΝΤΕΜΟΥ ΜΦΡΝ† ΝΡΩΜΙ ΝΙΒΕΝ. ⁷ ΙΤΕ ΙΩΧΦ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΤΕ ΝΘΟ, ΤΑΜΑΥ ΕΤ ΣΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ, Ν ΟΥΜΟΥ ΑΝ ΠΕ ΠΕΤΝΜΟΥ, ΑΛΛΑ ΟΥΩΝΗ ΠΕ ΝΕΝΕΖ, ΝΑΤΚΗΝ. ⁸ ΔΝΟΚ ΓΑΡ ΖΩ †ΝΑΜΟΥ ΉΑ ΠΙ-Ε-ΠΤΗΡΦ ΕΘΒΕ †ΣΑΡΖ ΝΡΕΦΜΟΥ | ΕΤ ΔΙΕΡ ΦΟΡΙΝ

¹ Now, as my father Joseph said these things, I did not refrain from shedding tears. And I wept as I looked at him (for, death had dominion over him), and as I heard the words of misery that he spoke. ² And, after these things, O my brothers, remember my death on the cross for the life of the whole world. ³ And my beloved mother Mary arose, she whose name is sweet in the mouth of all who love me; and she said to me in great grief, "Woe to me, my beloved Son; shall he die, he of the good and blessed old age, Joseph your beloved father, honourable according to flesh?" ⁴ I said to her, "O my beloved mother, who is there ever among men, who has worn flesh, that will not taste death?" ⁵ For, death is the ruler of mankind, O my blessed mother. ⁶ For, you also must die as all men. ⁷ Whether *it is* Joseph my father or you, my blessed mother, your death is not death but is life eternal *and* unceasing. ⁸ For, I also will die for the universe, because of the flesh that dies,

DEATH OF JOSEPH 18

- ¹ The literal translation of 'spoke' is 'speaks'.
² The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI* reads: *After these things, I remembered the day of My death, at the time that the Jews will set Me on the cross for the salvation of the whole world.*
³ At the start of this verse, *Borgianus CXXI* adds 'Straight away, I went to the court outside'.
⁴ Before 'men', *Borgianus CXXI* adds 'the race of'.
⁵ *Borgianus CXXI* reads: *For, death is the ruler of the whole world, even unto you, O Mary My blessed mother.*
⁶ *Borgianus CXXI* reads: *It is necessary that you also should die as all men.*
⁷ The words, 'it is' and 'and' (here presented in italics, following Robinson) are not in the MS but are implied.
⁸ *Borgianus CXXI* lacks 'that dies'.

ἵμος ἦν ἡ. ⁹ ἵνου χε, ὦ ταμαγ ἵμενριτ. τωογν, ἵτεωε νε
ἐβογν φα πιβελλο ετ σμαρωογτ ιωσηφ, φατεέμι ἐπιθωω εθ
ναωωπι ἵμοφ ἐβολῆεν πσισι.

which I wore in you. ⁹ Now, therefore, O my beloved mother,
arise and go to the blessed old man Joseph, until you know the
ordinance that shall come to him from on high.”

⁹ Another reading for ‘until you know’ is ‘that you may know’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 19

¹ ΟΥΟΖ ΑΣΤΩΝC, ΑCΩΕ ΝΑC ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΠΙΜΑ ΕΤΕΦΕΝΚΟΤ ΝΗΗΤC, ΟΥΟΖ ΑCΧΕΜC Ε Α ΠΙΜΗΝΙ ΝΤΕ ΦΜΟΥ ΟΥΩΝC-ΕΒΟΛ ΝΗΗΤC. ² ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΖΩ, ΝΑΜΕΝΡΑΤ, ΝΑΙΖΕΜCΙ ΗΑ ΤΕΦΑΦΕ, ΟΥΟΖ ΜΑΡΙΑ ΤΑΜΑΥ ΝΑCΖΕΜCΙ ΗΑΤΕΝ ΝΕΦΒΑΛΑΥΧ. ³ ΝΘΟΥ ΔΕ ΕΤ ΑΦΦΑΙ ΝΝΕΦΒΑΛ ΕΠΩΩΙ ΖΑ ΠΑΖΟ, ΝΠΕΦΩΧΕΜΧΟΜ ΝCΑΧΙ, ΧΕ Α ΤΟΥΝΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΦΜΟΥ ΕΡ ΒΟΙC ΕΡΟΥ. ⁴ ΛΟΙΠΟΝ ΕΤ ΑΦΦΑΙ ΝΝΕΦΒΑΛ ΕΠΩΩΙ, ΑΦΕΩ ΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΦΙ-ΑΖΟΜ ΕΒΟΛ. ⁵ ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΑΙΑΜΟΝΙ ΝΝΕΦΧΙΧ ΝΕΜ ΝΕΦΒΑΛΑΥΧ ΝΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΝΑΥ, ΕΦΧΟΥΩΤ ΕΡΟΙ ΟΥΟΖ ΕΦΤ ΖΟ ΕΡΟΙ ΧΕ ΝΠΕΡΧΑΤ, ΝΤΟΥΟΛΤ. ⁶ ΟΥΟΖ ΑΙΤ ΝΤΑΧΙΧ ΕΒΟΥΝ ΗΑ ΠΕΦΖΗΤ, ΑΙΧΙΜΙ ΝΤΕΦΤΥΧΗ Ε ΑΥΕΝC ΩΑ ΤΕΦΩΒΩΒΙ ΧΕ ΕΥΝΑΕΝC ΕΠΩΩΙ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΠΕΦCΩΜΑ, ΑΛΛΑ ΝΕ ΝΠΑΤΕ ΤΗΑΝ ΝΟΥΝΟΥ ΧΩΚ-ΕΒΟΛ ΠΕ ΕΘΡΕΦ Ι ΝΧΕ ΦΜΟΥ, ΝΜΟΝ ΝΑΦΝΑΕΡ ΚΑΤΕΧΙΝ ΑΝ ΠΕ, | ΧΕ ΟΥΝΙ ΝΑΡΕ ΠΩΘΟΡΤΕΡ ΟΥΕΖ ΝCΩΦ, ΟΥΟΖ ΦΡΙΜΙ ΝΕΜ ΠΤΑΚΟ ΕΘ ΜΩΩΙ ΗΑ ΤΕΦΖΗ.

¹ And she arose, and went into the place where he lay, and she found him with the sign of death manifest in him. ² And I also, my beloved ones, was sitting at his head, and Mary my mother was sitting by his feet. ³ And he lifted up his eyes to my face and was not able to speak; for, the hour of death had dominion over him. ⁴ Moreover, he lifted up his eyes, and he uttered a great groan. ⁵ And I held his hands and his feet for a great while, while he looked at me and besought me, *saying*, "Suffer me not to be taken away." ⁶ And I put my hand in under his heart, and I found his soul brought to his throat; for, it was about to be brought up from his body. But the last hour had not yet been fulfilled for Death to come; otherwise, he would not have held back; for, Confusion was following him, and Weeping and Destruction go before him.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 19

- ¹ For 'lay', the *Bohairic* MS has 'lies'.
- ² The *Sahidic* fragment, *Borgianus* CXXI, lacks 'my beloved ones'.
- ³ *Borgianus* CXXI ends, "because the dumbness of death had dominion over him."
- ⁴ In place of 'eyes', *Borgianus* CXXI has 'right hand'.
- ⁵ The word, 'saying', is not in the MS.
- ⁶ 'Death', 'Confusion', 'Weeping' and 'Destruction' are here personified.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 20

¹ ԵՆ ՔԻՆՈՐԵՍ ՆԱԿ ԷՐՈՒ ՆՃԷ ԿԱՄԵՆՐԻԿ ԻՄԱԿ ԵԼՃՈՄՃԷՄ
ԷՔԵԳՇՈՄԱ, ԱՇՃՈՄՃԷՄ ԶՈՇ ԷՆԵԳՇԱԼԱԿՃ, ԱՇՃԵՄՈՅ Է Ը ՔԻՆԻԿԻ
ՆԵՄ ՔԻՄՈՄ ԶՈԼ, ԱԳՃԱԿ. ² ՔԵՃԱՍ ՆԻԻ ԵՆ ՕԿՄԵԿԱԿՐԻԿ ՃԷ
ՔԵԶՄՈՏ ՓԻՔ, ՔԱՄԵՆՐԻԿ ՆՓԻՐԻ, ՃԷ ԻՇՃԵՆ ԴՕԿՆՈՅ ԵՏ ԱԿՃՈ
ՆԵԿՃԱԼՃ, ԷՃԵՆ ՔԵԳՇՈՄԱ, Ը ՔԻՄՈՄ ԵՐ ԸՆԱՃՈՐԻՆ ՆԱԳ. ³ ԻՍ
ՆԵԳՇԱԼԱԿՃ ՆԵՄ ՆԻՇԻՎԻ ՆԵՐ ՔԱԿՓ ՕՃԵՎ ՆՓԻԿ ԻՄԻՔԻՐԵՏԱԼՈՍ.
⁴ ԱՆՈԿ ԸԷ ԱԻՄՈՅԴ ԷՆԵԳՓԻՐԻ ՆԵՄ ՆԵԳՓԵՐԻ ԵԼՃՈ ԻՄՈՍ ՆՈՅՈՅ
ՃԷ ԿԵՆՈՒՆՈՅ, ՆԵԿԵՆՇԱԿԻ ՆԵՄ ՔԵԿԵՆԻՈՒԿ, ՃԷ ՔՇՈՅ ՔԷ ՓԱԻ
ՆՇԱԿԻ, ԻՔԱԵ ՔԻՐՈՓ ԵՏ ՇԱԿԻ ԿԻՆ, ՕԿՈՂ ՆԵՐ ԴՇԱՐՅ ՆԵՎԻՆ
ՈՃԵՎ. ⁵ ԿՈՒԵ ԱԿՇԱԿԻ ՆԵՄ ԻՈՇԿՓ ՆՃԷ ՆԵԳՓԻՐԻ ՆԵՄ ՆԵԳՓԵՐԻ.
ՄԱԳԵՐ ԿԻՆԸԻՆԵՅԻՆ ՔԷ ԵՅՅԷ ՔԻՅԻՍԻ ՆԵՐ ՓՄՈՅ ԵԳՈՅՈՒ ԷԻ
ԵՅՈԼԵՆ ՔԱԻ ԿՈՍՄՈՍ. ⁶ ԱՇԵՐ ՕԿՈ ՆՃԷ ԼՅԻՃԱ ԿՓԵՐԻ ՆԻՈՇԿՓ
ԵՇՃՈ ԻՄՈՍ ՆՆԵՍՇՆՈՅ ՃԷ ՕԿՈՒ ՆԻ, ՆԱՇՆՈՅ, ԷՐՈՒՔ | ՓԱԻ
ԱՆ ՔԷ ՔՐՈՒՆԻ ՆԵՆՄԵՆՐԻԿ ԻՄԱԿ, ՓԱ ԴՆՈՅ ԻՔԵՆՆԱԿ ԷՐՈՍ.
⁷ ՓԱԻ ՕՆ ՔԷ ԻՓՐԻԿ ԻՔԵՆԻՈՒԿ ԻՈՇԿՓ, ԶԻՆԱ ՆԵՆՐԵՄՄԱԿ
ԷՐՈՓ ՓԱ ԷՆԵՂ ⁸ ԿՈՒԵ ԱԿՇԻՍԻ ՆԵՐՈՅՇՆԻ ԷՂՐԻ ՆՃԷ ՆԵՆՐԵՐԻ
ՆԻՈՇԿՓ, ԱԿՐԻՄԻ. ԱՆՈԿ ԸԷ ԶՈ ՆԵՄ ՄԱՐԻԱ ԿԱՄԱԿ ԻՔԱՐԵՆՈՍ
ԱՆՐԻՄԻ ՆԵՄՈՅՈՅ, ՃԷ ՕԿԻ Ը ԴՆՈՅ ՆԵՐ ՓՄՈՅ ՓՈՂ.

¹ When my beloved mother saw me touching his body, she also touched his feet, and she found that the breath and the heat had gone and left them. ² She said to me in guilelessness, “Thanks be to you, my beloved Son; for, from the hour that you put your hand on his body, the heat withdrew from him. ³ Behold, his feet and his legs are cold as crystal.” ⁴ And I called his sons and his daughters, saying to them, “Arise, and speak with your father; for, this is the time to speak, before the mouth that speaks fails, and the wretched flesh is cold.” ⁵ Then his sons and his daughters spoke with Joseph. He was in danger because of the suffering of death, wishing to go forth from this world. ⁶ Lysia the daughter of Joseph answered and said to her brothers, “Woe to me, my brothers; is this not the sickness of our beloved mother, and until now we have not seen her? ⁷ This also is that which happens to our father Joseph, that we should not see him for ever. ⁸ Then the children of Joseph lifted up their voice and wept. And I also and Mary My virgin mother wept with them; for, the hour of death was come.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 20

- ¹ Another reading for ‘heat’ is ‘fever’ (as also in v. 2)
- ² The literal translation of ‘withdrew from him’ is ‘withdrew for him’.
- ³ In place of ‘crystal’, the Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, has ‘ice and snow’.
- ⁴ At the start of this vers, *Borgianus CXXI* adds ‘I moved my head and’.
- ⁵ *Borgianus CXXI* ends, “being near to be separated from this life.”
- ⁶ A more literal translation of ‘is this not’ is ‘if this is not’.
- ⁷ Literally translated, the verse opens, “This is the manner of.”
- ⁸ One could (more properly) read ‘sons’ for ‘children’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 21

¹ ἄνοκ δε αἰκομς ἐνῖκα ἵτε φρης, αἰναγ ἐφμογ, αqι ἡατεν
πῖνι, ἐρε ἄμεντ ογεζ ἵκωq, ἐτε φαι πε ετ οι ἵοργανοῖν ναq
nem πιcιᾶβολος, ἐρε ογον ογμνω ἵδανκανος ογεζ ἵκωq εγcι
qβωc ἵκρωm, ἵ μαοτογ ἵππ ἵμαγ, ἐρε ογκαπνος nem οἶθην
νηογ ἐβολῆεν pωογ. ² παιωτ δε ἰωcηφ ετ αqχογωτ, αqναγ
ἐνν ετ αqι ἵκωq εγμαg ἵκωντ ἐβογν ἐροq κατα φρητ ἐτε
ωαγμοg ἵπογqο ἵκωντ ἐβογν ἐγγχην νῖβεν εθ νηογ ἐβολῆεν
cωμα, μαλῖcτα νῖρεqερνοβι ετ ογναcῖμῖ ἵογκογcῖ ἵτωογ
ἵῃητογ. ³ ἡεν πcῖνῶρε φα τμετῃελλο εθ | nanec naγ ἐpωογ
ἐρε φμογ nemωογ, ἁ neqβαλ τ εpmη. ⁴ ἡεν τoγνογ ἐτεmμαγ
ἁ τγγχην εcωῖνῖ ἵca ογμωῖτ ἐχωπ, qοπωc ἵτεcογcῖαι. ⁵ ἡεν
πcῖνῶρι naγ ἐπqι-ἄqom ἵπαιωτ ἰωcηφ, cε αqναγ
ἐqανεζογcῖᾶ ἐτε ἵπαqναγ ἐpωογ ἐνεg, αἷτωnt ἵτoγνογ,
αιερ ἐπῖτιμαν ἵπῖαῖβολος nem νη εθ nemαq τηρογ. ⁶ nωογ
δε αγωε nωογ ἡεν ογωῖπῖ nem ογνῖωτ ἵωθoρτερ. ⁷ ογοg
ἵπε qῖ ἵpωmῖ ἡεν νη ετ qemci ἡεν πκωτ ἵπαιωτ ἰωcηφ ἐmῖ,
ογδε μαpῖᾶ ταμαγ, εθβε νῖταzῖc τηρογ ἵqοτ εθ νηογ ἵca
τγγχην ἵνῖpωma. ⁸ ἡεν πcῖνῶρεq naγ δε ἵcε φμογ cε αιερ

¹ Now, I looked towards the south, and I saw Death. He came
to the house, Amenti following him, who is his instrument,
and the devil, many attendants following him, clothed with
fire, without number, smoke and brimstone coming forth from
their mouths. ² And my father Joseph looked, and he saw those
who came after him, full of anger towards him; even as they
burn in their face with anger towards every soul that comes
forth from *the* body, especially the sinners, in whom they will
find a little of their own. ³ When the good old man saw them,
Death being with them, he wept. ⁴ In that hour, the soul of my
father Joseph was distracted with great groaning, seeking a
way to be hidden, in order that it might be saved. ⁵ When I saw
the groaning of my father Joseph (for, he saw powers that he
had never seen), I arose straight away and rebuked the devil
and all those who *were* with him. ⁶ And they went in shame
and in great confusion. ⁷ And no man among those who sat
about my father Joseph knew, not even Mary my mother,
concerning all the fearful hosts that come after the soul of men.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 21

- ¹ One could read ‘*near the house*’ in place of ‘*to the house*’.
- ² The *Bohairic* MS has no article before ‘*body*’.
- ³ The literal translation of ‘*he wept*’ is ‘*his eyes wept*’.
- ⁴ Another reading for ‘*distracted*’ is ‘*divided*’.
- ⁵ The parentheses in this verse follow Robinson.
- ⁶ For this verse, the Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus* CXXI reads just, “*They fled in great shame.*”
- ⁷ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus* CXXI lacks ‘*concerning ... soul of men*’.

ἐπιτιμᾶν ἡνιέζουσιᾶ ἡτε πᾶκι, ἀριτοῦ ἐβολ, εἴθε δε ἡμον
ἐλι ἡνιέζουσιᾶ ντῶου ἐξῶφ, ἀφερ ῥοτ. ⁹ ἀνοκ δε αἰτῶντ
ἡτοῦνοῦ, αἰξῶ ἡοῦπροσεῦχη ἐπῶωι ῥα παῖωτ φα
ἡμετῶενζητ ἐτ οῶ εἰξῶ ἡμοc δε

⁸ Now when Death saw that I rebuked the powers of darkness
and put them forth, because they had no power over him, he
was afraid. ⁹ And I arose straight away, and I offered up a
prayer to my Father the exceeding merciful, saying,

⁸ For the word translated '*had*', the *Bohairic MS* has a present tense verb.

⁹ The literal translation of '*the exceedingly merciful*' is '*him of the many mercies*'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 22

¹ παιωτ ογορ | φωτ ντε μετωενζητ νιβεν, φωτ ντε
†μεθμη, πβαλ ἡρεφναγ, πμαωχ ἡρεφωτεμ, σωτεμ
ἐπεκμενριτ ἡωηρι ἔτε ἀνοκ πε, ει† ρο ἐροκ εθε πεωβ
ἡνεκχιχ ἔτε παιωτ ιωσφ πε, ἡτεκογωρπ νηι ἡογνιω†
ἡχορος ἡαγγελος νემ μιχαηλ ποικονομος ἡτε †μετὰγαθος
νემ γαβριηλ πικαιωενογχι ντε φογωνι, ἡσεμοωι νემ τ†γχι
ἡπαιωτ ιωσφ, ωατεccini ἡπιζ ἡέων ἡχακι, ογορ ον χε
ἡνεccini ἡεν νιμωιτ ετ ρεχρωχ, ναι ἔτε ογρο† τε ἐμοωι
ἡῃτογ, ογορ ογνιω† ἡνο† πε ἔναγ ἐνιδγναμис ετ χη ρι
χωου, ἐρε πιαρο ἡχρωμ ἡεν πμα ἔτεμμαγ εφcek ἡα† ἡφρη†
ννιχολ ἡτε φιομ ² ογορ ωωπι ἡναντ ἐβογν ε†γχι ἡπαιωτ
ιωσφ εφνηογ ἐβρηι ἐνεκχιχ εθ ογав, χε θαι τε †ογνογ
ετεφερ χριὰ ἡπιναι ἡῃτс. ³ †χω ἡμος νωτεν, ω νасηноγ
ετ ταιῡογт ογορ ναάπαοc|τολος ετ сμарωογт, χε ρωμ
νιβεν ετ αγχοφ ἐπικосмос, ετ аqemi ἐπιπεθнанеq νем
πιπεθωου, ἐ αφερ πεφchoγ τηρφ εqάωι ἡca νιβογχι ἡτε
неqβαλ, qep ἡχриа ἡпенαι ἡτε παιωτ ἡαγαθος, αqωани
ε†ογноγ ἡτε φμογ νем †χincini ἡτε πимωи ἡμοωι νем
пвнма εт οи ἡρο† νем πχινер ἀπολογicεε. ⁴ πλην †ναταcθοи
εχεν πχини ἐβολῃεν cωма ἡτε παιωτ ιωσφ πῃελλο ἡθμη.

¹ “My Father and the Father of all mercies, the Father of truth,
the Eye that sees, and the Ear that hears, hear your beloved
Son, even me, as I beseech you for the work of your hands,
even my father Joseph – that you may send me a great choir of
angels, and Michael, the steward of goodness, and Gabriel, the
evangelist of light; *and* that they may go with the soul of my
father Joseph, until it passes by the seven aeons of darkness;
and also, that it may not pass through the narrow ways,
wherein it is fearful to go, and it is very fearful to see the
powers that are on them, the river of fire flowing there as the
waves of the sea. ² And be merciful towards the soul of my
father Joseph as he comes to your holy hands; for, this is the
hour in which he has need of mercy.” ³ I say to you, O my
honourable brothers and my blessed apostles, that every man,
who is born into the world, who has known good and evil,
spending all his time hanging from his eyelids, has need of the
mercy of my good Father, when he comes to the hour of death,
and to the passing of the path, and to the fearful judgment seat,
and to the making of a defence. ⁴ But I will turn to the going
forth from *the* body of my father Joseph, the righteous old man.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 22

- ¹ The word translated ‘*mercies*’ could also be read as a singular noun.
² The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, has ‘*gentle*’ in place of ‘*merciful*’.
³ Another reading for ‘*honourable*’ is ‘*glorious*’.
⁴ The *Bohairic MS* has no article before ‘*body*’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 23

¹ ΕΤ ΑΦΤ ΔΕ ΉΠΕΦΠΝΕΥΜΑ, ΔΙΕΡ ΑΣΠΑΖΕCΘΕ ΉΜΟΦ. ² ΑΥCΙ
ΉΤΕΦΨΥΧΗ ΉΔΕ ΝΙΑΓΓΕΛΟC, ΑΥΤΗC ΕΉΡΗΙ ΕΞΑΝΜΑΠΠΑ ΉΘΕΝC
ΉΟΛΟCΙΠΙΚΟΝ. ³ ΕΤ ΔΙΩΕ ΔΕ ΕΒΟΥΝ, ΔΙΞΕΜCΙ ΉΔ ΤΟΤΦ, ΉΠΕ ΖΛΙ
ΉΡΩΜΙ ΕΜΙ ΧΕ ΑΦΜΟΥ, ΉΕΝ ΝΗ ΕΤ ΖΕΜCΙ ΉΠΕΦΚΩΤ. ⁴ ΟΥΟZ
ΔΙΟΡΕ ΜΙΧΑΗΛ ΝΕΜ ΓΑΒΡΙΗΛ ΡΩΙC ΕΤΕΦΨΥΧΗ ΕΘΒΕ ΝΙΕΖΟΥCΙΑ
ΕΤ ΖΙ ΠΙΜΩΙΤ, ΟΥΟZ Δ ΝΙΑΓΓΕΛΟC ΖΩC ΉΔ ΧΩC, ΩΑΤΟΥΤΗC
ΉΠΑΙΩΤ ΉΔΓΑΘΟC.

¹ Now, when he gave up his spirit, I saluted him. ² The angels
took his soul and put it into silken napkins of fine texture. ³ And,
when I went in, I sat by him; and no man knew that he was dead,
among those who sat about him. ⁴ And I caused Michael and
Gabriel to watch his soul because of the powers that *were* in the
way; and the angels sang before it, until they gave it to my good
Father.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 23

- ¹ The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, has a very different (and much longer) text for this chapter.
² The phrase, 'fine texture' could also be read as 'byssus'.
³ *Borgianus CXXI* reads: *And, straight away, numbness (?) and panting for breath rose against him exceedingly, and I knew that the burning hour was come.*
⁴ The *Bohairic MS* does not have the verb, 'were', though it is implied.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 24

¹ αἰτᾶσθες δε ἔχεν πῶμα ἰμπαῖωτ ἰωσὴφ ἐφχῃ ἔβρη ἰμφρητ ἰνοῦκοῦφον ἐφωοῖτ, οὐοὺ αἰρεμσι αἰῖνι ἰνεφβαλ ἔβρη, | αἰμαφθαῖ ἰμωοῦ nem pωq, αἰόρι εἰχοῦωτ ἔβρη ἔχωq. ² πεχῃ ἰτπαρθενος xε ὦ μαριὰ ταμαγ, αῦ ὅων τῆνοῦ ρωβ nιβεν ἰμεττεχνιτης ετ ἂ φαι αἰτοῦ ἰχxεν τεφμετκοῦχι ωα ἔβοῦν ἔτῆνοῦ; αῦσι τῆροῦ βεν ται οῦνοῦ ἰνοῦωτ ἰχxεκ ἰποῦxφωq ἐπικοςμος ἐπτῆρηq. ³ βεν πxῖνθροῦ cωtem ἐροι ἰxε ἰνεφωρη nem neφωepi εἰxω ἰναι ἰμαριὰ ταμαγ ἰπαρθενος πεxωοῦνη ἰαμοῦ ἰxε πενῖωτ, οὐοὺ ἰπενῆνι; ⁴ πεχῃ nωοῦ xε βεν οῦμεῶμη ἰαμοῦ, ἀλλα ἰ οῦμοῦ αν πε φμοῦ ἰωσὴφ παῖωτ, ἀλλα οῦωνῃ ωα ἔνεε. ⁵ νη ετεφνασιτοῦν ἰxε παμενριτ ἰωτ ἰωσὴφ, ραννῖωτ ne: ἰχxεν τῶγῆνοῦ γαρ ετ ἂ τεφῦγχη ἰ εβολῃεν cωμα, ἂ βῖσι nιβεν κῆν nαρραq: αqωε nαq ἔτμετοῦρο ωα ἔνεε, αqω ἰcωq ἰμῆροῦ ἰπῖcωμα, αqω ἰcωq ἰπαι κοcμος εῶ μερ ἰβῖσι nιβεν nem pωοῦω nιβεν ετ ωοῖτ, | αqωε nαq ἐνῖμα ἰνεμτον ἰτε παῖωτ ετ βεν νῖφῆοῖ, νη ἔτε ἰπαῦτακο ωα ἔνεε. ⁶ ναι δε ετ αἰχοτοῦ ἰναcνηοῦ xε αqμοῦ ἰxε πετενῖωτ ἰωσὴφ πῖβελλο ετ

¹ And I turned to the body of my father Joseph, laid down like an empty vessel, and I sat and I drew down his eyes, and I closed them and his mouth; and I stayed looking down at him. ² I said to the Virgin, “O Mary my mother, where now are all works of trade which this man has wrought from his youth until now? They all have passed away in this one hour, as though he had not been born into the world at all.” ³ When his sons and his daughters heard me saying these things to Mary my virgin mother, they said to me with great weeping, “Woe to us, O our Lord. Is our father dead and we did not know it?” ⁴ I said to them, “In truth he is dead. But the death of Joseph my father is not death but eternal life. ⁵ The *blessings* my beloved father Joseph will receive are great. For, from the hour that his soul went forth from *the* body, all trouble ceased for him. He went into the kingdom for ever. He left behind him the burden of the body. He left behind him this world full of all troubles and all vain cares. He went into the resting places of my Father who is in the heavens, which are never destroyed.” ⁶ Now, when I had said these things to my brothers, ‘Your father Joseph, the blessed old

DEATH OF JOSEPH 24

- ¹ An alternative reading for ‘*stayed*’ is ‘*stood*’.
- ² The Sahidic fragment, *Borgianus CXXI*, ends after the first word of this verse.
- ³ Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns that refer to Jesus.
- ⁴ Robinson has ‘*life for ever*’ in place of ‘*eternal life*’.
- ⁵ The MS has no article before ‘*body*’.
- ⁶ Robinson has ‘*great while*’ in place of ‘*long time*’.

[illegible]

man, is dead,' they arose; they tore their garments and they wept for a long time.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 25

¹ ΤΟΤΕ ΝΑ ΤΒΑΚΙ ΤΗΡC ΝΑΖΑΡΕΘ ΝΕΜ ΝΑ ΤΓΑΛΙΛΕΑ ΕΤ
ΑΥCΩΤΕΜ ΕΠΙΨΒΙ, ΑΥΘΩΟΥΤ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΕΠΙΜΑ Ε ΝΑΝΧΗ ΜΜΟQ,
ΚΑΤΑ ΦΝΟΜΟC ΝΝΠΟΥΔΑΙ, ΑΥΕΡ ΠΙΕΞΟΥ ΤΗΡQ ΕΥΕΡ ΖΗΒΙ ΕΡΟQ
ΩΑ ΦΝΑΥ ΝΑΧΠΘΤ. ² ΉΕΝ ΦΝΑΥ ΔΕ ΠΑΧΠΘΤ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΕΞΟΥ
ΑΙΘΡΟΥ ΖΙΟΥΓΙ-ΕΒΟΛ ΝΟΥΟΝ ΝΙΒΕΝ, ΑΙΖΙΟΥΓΙ ΝΟΥΜΩΟΥ ΕΧΕΝ
ΠCΩΜΑ ΜΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΙΩΤ ΙΩCΗΦ, ΑΙΘΑΖCQ ΉΕΝ ΟΥΝΕΖ ΝCΘΟΙ
ΝΟΥQΙ, ΑΙΤΩΒΖ ΜΠΑΙΩΤ ΝΑΓΑΘΟC ΕΤ ΉΕΝ ΝΙΦΗΟΥΓΙ, ΉΕΝ
ΖΑΝΠΡΟCΕΥΧΗ ΝΕΠΩΡΑΝΙΟΝ ΝΑΙ ΕΤ ΑΙCΨΗΤΟΥ ΉΕΝ ΝΑΤΗΒ ΜΜΙΝ
ΜΜΟΙ ΉΕΝ ΝΙΠΛΑΖ ΝΤΕ ΤΦΕ ΜΠΑΤCΙ CΑΡΖ ΉΕΝ ΤΠΑΡΘΕΝΟC ΕΘ
ΟΥΑΒ ΜΑΡΙΔ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ ΉΕΝ ΤΟΥΝΟΥ ΕΤ ΑΙΤ ΜΠΑΜΗΝ ΝΤΕ
ΤΠΡΟCΕΥΧΗ, ΑΥΙ ΝΧΕ ΟΥΜΗΩ ΝΑΓΓΕΛΟC, ΑΙΟΥΑΖCΑΖΝΙ ΕΘΡΕ Β
ΝΨΗΤΟΥ ΦΩΡΩ ΝΟΥCΤΟΛΗ, ΑΙΘΡΟΥ ΩΛΙ ΜΠΙCΩΜΑ ΕΤ
CΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ ΝΤΕ ΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩCΗΦ, ΝCΕΤΗΙQ ΕΘΜΗΤ ΝΝΙΖΒΩC,
ΝCΕΚΟΥΛΩΛQ.

¹ Then the inhabitants of all the city of Nazareth and the
inhabitants of Galilee, when they heard the mourning, gathered
to the place where we were, according to the law of the Jews;
and they spent all day mourning for him, until the ninth hour.
² Now, at the ninth hour of the day, I caused all to be put forth.
I put water on the body of my beloved father Joseph, and I
anointed him with sweet smelling oil. I prayed to my good
Father who is in the heavens with heavenly prayers, which I
wrote with my own fingers on the tables of heaven, before I took
flesh in the holy Virgin Mary. ³ And, straight away, when I had
said the Amen of the prayer, there came a multitude of angels,
and I commanded two of them to spread a robe, and I made
them take up the blessed body of my father Joseph and put it
into the midst of the garments and shroud it.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 25

- ¹ Before 'gathered', Robinson has 'they all were'.
² In place of 'put water', Robinson has 'poured water'.
³ The literal translation of 'had said' is 'had given'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 26

¹ ΟΥΟΖ ΔΙΧΩ ΝΝΑΧΙ ΕΧΕΝ ΠΕΥΣΩΜΑ ΕΙΧΩ ΜΜΟC ΧΕ ΝΝΕ CΘΟΙ
ΒΩΝ ΝΤΕ ΦΜΟΥ ΕΡ CΟΙC ΕΡΟΚ, ΟΥΔΕ ΝΝΕ ΝΕΚΜΑΩΧ ΧΩΝΕ,
ΟΥΔΕ ΝΝΕ ΤΙΑΒΙ ΩΟΥΟ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΠΕΚCΩΜΑ ΩΑ ΕΝΕΖ, ΟΥΔΕ
ΝΝΕCΛΟΥΛΕΥ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΠΚΑΖΙ ΝΧΕ ΤΕΚΚΑΙCΙ ΟΥΔΕ ΡΕΚCΑΡΖ ΕΤ
ΑΙΤΗCΙC ΖΙΩΤΚ, ΑΛΛΑ ΕCΕΟΖΙ ΉΕΝ ΠΕΚCΩΜΑ ΩΑ ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΝΤΕ
ΠΙΔΙΠΝΟΝ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΩΟ ΝΡΟΜΠΙ, ΝΝΕ ΝΙΩΩ ΝΤΕ ΤΕΚΑΦΕ ΛΩΜ, ΝΑΙ
ΕΤ ΔΙΑΜΟΝΙ ΜΜΟΥ ΉΕΝ ΝΑΧΙΧ ΝΟΥΜΗΩ ΝCΟΠ, Ω ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ
ΝΙΩΤ ΙΩCΗΦ, ΟΥΟΖ ΠΠΕΘΝΑΝΕΥ ΝΑΩΩΠΙ ΜΜΟΚ. ² ΝΗ ΕΘ ΝΑΦΙ
ΦΡΩΟΥΩ ΝΟΥΠΡΟCΦΟΡΑ, ΝCΕΤΝΙC ΕΪΟΥΝ ΕΠΕΚΤΟΠΟC ΉΕΝ
ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΕΚΕΡ ΦΜΕΥΙ, ΕΤΕ CΟΥΚCΘ ΝΠΑΒΟΤ ΕΠΗΠ ΠΕ, ΤΝΑΤ
CΜΟΥ ΝΑΦ ΖΩ ΉΕΝ ΤΠΡΟCΦΟΡΑ ΝΕΩΡΑΝΙΟΝ ΕΤ ΉΕΝ ΝΙΦΗΟΥΙ.
³ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΦΗ ΕΘ ΝΑΤ ΝΟΥΩΙΚ ΕΤΧΙΧ ΝΟΥΖΗΚΙ ΉΕΝ ΠΕΚΡΑΝ,
ΤΝΑΧΑΦ ΔΝ ΕΕΡ ΖΑΕ ΝΖΛΙ ΝΑΓΑΘΟΝ ΝΤΕ ΠΑΙ ΚΟCΜΟC ΉΕΝ
ΝΙΕΖΟΥ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΕΥΩΝΉ. ⁴ ΝΗ ΕΘ ΝΑΤ ΝΟΥΑΦΟΤ ΝΚΡΠ
ΕΤΧΙΧ ΝΟΥΩΕΜΜΟ ΝΡΩΜΙ ΙΕ ΟΥΧΗΡΑ ΙΕ ΟΥΟΡΦΑΝΟC ΉΕΝ
ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΝΤΕ ΠΕΚΕΡ ΦΜΕΥΙ, ΤΝΑΕΡ ΧΑΡΙΖΕCΘΕ ΜΜΩΟΥ ΝΑΚ
ΕΘΡΕΚ ΟΛΟΥ ΕΠΙΔΙΠΝΟΝ ΝΤΕ ΠΙΩΟ ΝΡΟΜΠΙ. ⁵ ΝΗ ΕΘ ΝΑCΉΔΙ
ΝΠΧΩΜ ΝΤΕ ΠΕΚΧΙΝΙ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ CΩΜΑ ΝΕΜ ΠΙCΑΧΙ ΤΗΡΟΥ ΕΤ
ΑΓΙ ΕΒΟΛΗΕΝ ΡΩΙ ΜΦΟΥ, ΩΕ ΠΕΚΟΥΧΑΙ, Ω ΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ΝΙΩΤ
ΙΩCΗΦ, ΧΕ ΤΝΑΕΡ ΧΑΡΙΖΕCΘΕ ΜΜΩΟΥ ΝΑΚ ΉΕΝ ΠΑΙ ΚΟCΜΟC,

¹ And I placed my hands on his body, saying, "Let no evil smell
of death have dominion over you, neither let your ears stink,
and let corruption never flow forth from your body, neither let
your shroud nor your flesh, with which I have clothed you, rot
in the earth, but let it remain on your body to the day of the
supper of the thousand years. Let not the hair of your head
waste away, of which I took hold with my hands many times, O
my beloved father Joseph; and it shall be well with you. ² They
who take thought for an offering and present it to your shrine
on the day of your memorial, even the twenty-sixth of the
month Epep; I will bless him also in the heavenly offering that
is in the heavens. ³ And also, he who gives bread into the hand
of a poor man in your name, I will not suffer him to lack any
good thing of this world in all the days of his life. ⁴ They who
give a cup of wine into the hand of a stranger or of a widow or
of an orphan on the day of your memorial, I will grant them to
you to take them to the supper of the thousand years. ⁵ They
who write the book of your going forth from *the* body, and all
the words that have come forth from my mouth today, I *swear*
by your life, O my beloved father Joseph, that I will grant them

DEATH OF JOSEPH 26

- ¹ The 'supper of the thousand years' is a major theme of Egyptian Christianity.
² In place of 'bless him', here following the *MS*, Robinson has 'bless each one of them'.
³ Robinson has 'shall give' in place of 'gives'.
⁴ See #1.
⁵ The *MS* has no article before 'body' (twice in this verse).

οὐτος οὐκ ἀγῶνι ἐβόληεν σῶμα, †ναφῶς ἡπιχορογραφον
ἢτε νοῦνοβι, ἡτοῦτῃς ἐλὶ ἡβάσανος ἐβηλ ἐτεναγκῇ
ἡφμοῦ νῆμ πιαρο ἡχρῶν ἐτ χη ἡπεμθο ἡπαιῶτ, φαι ἐτ ἐρ
καθαρίζιν ἡψχῇ νιβεν. ⁶ οὐτος ἐῶπ οὐχῇ ἡρῶνι πε,
ἡμον ἡταῖ ἐίρι ἡνῇ ἐτ αἰχοτοῦ, ἀγῶνις ἡοῦτῃς,
ἡτεῖτ πεν πεφραν χε ἡσῇ, ἐτ ὡοῦ ἡπεκραν, | ἡνε ῖβων
οὐδε μετλοίμος ὡπῇ ἡεν πῇ ἐτεμμαῦ, χε οὐκ ἡκραν
χη ἡῇτῃ.

to you in this world; and also, when they go forth from *the* body,
I will tear the bond of their sins, that they may not receive any
torment, save the necessity of death and the river of fire that is
before my Father, which cleanses all souls. ⁶ And, if he is a poor
man, and has not *wherewithal* to do those things that I have said,
if he fathers a son, and calls his name Joseph, glorifying your
name, famine and pestilence shall not be in that house, because
your name is in it.”

⁶ The MS does not have the word, ‘*wherewithal*’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 27

¹ ΜΕΝΕΝCΑ ΝΑΙ ΑΓΙ ΕΠΙΜΑ Ε ΝΑΡΕ ΠCΩΜΑ ΜΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩCΗΦ ΧΗ
ΝΪΗΤQ, ΝΧΕ ΝΙΝΙΩΤ ΝΤΕ ΤΒΑΚΙ, ΕΡΕ ΝΙΡΕQΚΩC ΜΟΩΙ
ΝΕΜΩΟΥ, ΕΥΟΥΩΩ ΕΚΩC ΜΠΕQCΩΜΑ ΚΑΤΑ ΤΧΙΝΚΩC ΝΤΕ
ΝΠΟΥΔΑΙ. ² ΟΥΟZ ΑΥΧΕΜQ Ε ΑΥΚΗΝ ΕΚΩC ΜΜΟQ, Ε Α ΤΚΑΙCΙ
ΧΩΛΧ ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΠΕQCΩΜΑ ΖΩC ΙCΧΕΚ ΕΤ ΑΥΧΟΛΧC ΉΕΝ
ΖΑΝΦΕΡΟΝΙ ΜΒΕΝΙΠΙ, ΟΥΟZ ΕΤ ΑΥΚΙΜ ΕΡΟQ, ΜΠΟΥΧΕΜ ΖΛΙ ΜΡΟ
ΉΕΝ ΤΚΑΙCΙ. ³ ΜΕΝΕΝCΑ ΝΑΙ ΔΕ ΑΥΟΛQ ΕΒΟΛ ΕΠΙΜΖΑΥ. ⁴ ΕΤ
ΑΥΩΩΚΙ ΔΕ ΖΙ ΡΩQ ΜΠΙCΠΗΛΕΟΝ ΧΕ ΑΥΝΑΟΥΩΝ ΜΡΩQ,
ΝCΕΧΑQ ΉΑΤΕΝ ΝΕQΙΟΤ, ΔΙΕΡ ΦΜΕΥΙ ΜΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΕΤ ΑQΜΟΩΙ
ΝΕΜΗΙ ΕΒΡΗΙ ΕΧΗΜΙ ΝΕΜ ΝΙΝΙΩΤ ΝΩΘΟΡΤΕΡ ΕΤ ΑQΩΟΠΟΥ
ΕΘΒΗΤ, ΟΥΟZ ΔΙΦΟΡΩΤ ΕΒΟΛ ΕΧΕΝ ΠΕQCΩΜΑ, ΔΙΡΙΜΙ ΕΡΟQ
ΝΟΥΝΙΩΤ ΝΝΑΥ ΕΙΧΩ ΜΜΟC ΧΕ

¹ After this, the great ones of the city came to the place in which
the body of my father Joseph was laid, they who prepare for
burial going with them, wishing to prepare his body according
to the burying of the Jews. ² And they found it already prepared,
the shroud having been fastened to his body, as though it were
fastened with iron clasps; and, when they moved him, they found
no entrance in the shroud. ³ And, after this, they took him out to
the tomb. ⁴ And, when they had dug at the door of the cave, to
open its door and lay him with his fathers, I remembered the day
that he went down with me into Egypt, and the great troubles
that he suffered because of me; and I stretched myself out on his
body, and I wept for him for a long time, saying:

DEATH OF JOSEPH 27

- ¹ Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns referring to Jesus.
² The translation, 'iron clasps' is uncertain (Robinson adds a question mark in parentheses).
³ Robinson opens, "And, after these things."
⁴ Robinson has 'great while' in place of 'long time'.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 28

¹ ὦ ψμοῦ, φη ἐτ τοῖνος ἡζανρῖμι εὔωψ nem ζαννεζπι
ἐναψωοῦ: ἀλλὰ φη ἐτ ζῖχεν οὔον ηῖβεν, ἡθοῦ | π' ἐτ ἀφτ
νακ ἵται ἐζοῦσιὰ ἐτ οἱ ἡψφῆρι. ² ἀλλὰ ἡμον ἀρῖκι σῖ
ἐφμοῦ ἡφρζτ ἡάδαμ nem τεφςζῖμι. ³ φμοῦ δε ἡπαφερ ζλι
ἡζωβ ἀσνε πογὰρζαζνι ἡτε παῖωτ. ⁴ οὔορ οὔον ρωμι
ἡμαγ ἐ αφερ ὅ ἡψε ἡρομῖ ἡπατεφμοῦ, ζανκεμῆψ δε οἷ
αῡερ ζοῡο ἐναῖ. ⁵ ἡπε οὔαι ἡῖῆτοῦ χος χε ἀῖναγ ἐφμοῦ ἡε
χε εφῖνοῦ κατὰ χοῦ εφτ ἡῖσι ἡζλι. ⁶ ἀλλὰ ἡπαφτ ἡῖσι
ἡωοῦ ἐβῆλ ἐοῡσοπ ἡοῡωτ, οὔορ πῖκεσοπ ἐτεμῖμαγ παῖωτ
ἡάγαθος πε εῶ οὔωρπ| ἡμοῦ ἡῖα πῖρωμι. ⁷ ἡπῖναγ δε ἐ
ψαφῖ ἡωω, ψαφςωτεῖ ἡάποφαςῖς εςῖνοῦ ἐβολῆεν τφε.
⁸ εῡωπ ἐρε ἡάποφαςῖς ἡνοῦ ἡεν οὔωθορτερ οὔορ εςμεζ
ἡχωντ, ψαρε φμοῦ ἡ ζωψ ἡεν οὔωθορτερ nem οὔμβον,
ἡτεφχωκ-ἐβολ ἡπιογὰρζαζνι ἡτε παῖωτ ἡάγαθος, ἡτεφῖ
ἡτῡῡῡ ἡπῖρωμι, πτεφῖς ἡπεφῖοῖς. ⁹ ἡπαψχεμχом ἡχε
φμοῦ ἐζῖτψ εῡῡχρωм οὔδε ἐζῖτψ ἐῡμετοῡρο ἡτε ἡῖφῖοῡῖ.

¹ “O death, that stirs up much mourning and many lamentations
– but he who is over all, he it is who has given you this wonderful
power. ² But death is not to blame, like Adam and his wife; ³ and
death does nothing without the command of my Father. ⁴ And
there is *a* man who has lived nine hundred years before
he died, and many others also have lived more than that: ⁵ yet,
not one of them said, ‘I have seen death,’ or that he comes
from time to time troubling anyone. ⁶ But he does not trouble
them save one time; and that time also it is my good Father
who sends him after the man. ⁷ And, at the hour that he
comes after him, he hears the sentence coming from heaven. ⁸ If
the sentence comes in confusion and is full of anger, death also
comes in confusion and in wrath, that he may fulfil the command
of my good Father, and receive the soul of the man, and give
it to his Lord. ⁹ Death is not able to cast him into the fire nor to
bring him into the kingdom of the heavens. ¹⁰ As for death, it is

DEATH OF JOSEPH 28

- ¹ The Coptic words translated ‘*much*’ and ‘*many*’ are different.
- ² Jesus here attributes sadness in the world to Adam and Eve (and see v. 13).
- ³ Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns that refer to Jesus/God.
- ⁴ Cf., for example, Methuselah.
- ⁵ Robinson has the opening ‘*yet*’ in italics.
- ⁶ Jesus uses the phrase, ‘*my good Father*’, 12 times in the text of this book.
- ⁷ Another possible reading for ‘*sentence*’ is ‘*voice*’.
- ⁸ See #7.
- ⁹ The word translated ‘*bring*’ is the same as that translated ‘*cast*’ (ἐζῖτψ).
- ¹⁰ The literal translation of ‘*rather*’ is ‘*also*’.

| ¹⁰ πρῶτον μὲν, προῤῥαζομένη ἵνα φανήται πᾶσι ὅτι ἐφίρει ἡμῶν, ἄδამ δὲ, ἡθὺς ὑπεφίρει ἡφουῶν ἡπαῖον, ἀλλὰ καὶ παραβάσις, ἀφαις, ὡστε παῖον ἔωντ ἔρος ἦεν πλῖνοντες ὥστε ἡσά τεφρῶμι, οὐδὲ ἡτεφρ ἄτῶντ ἡσά παῖον ἡἀγαθός, ὡστεφῖνι ἡφῶν ἔχεν ὕχην ἡνεν ¹¹ ἐνέ ἡπε ἄδამ ἐρ ἄτῶντ ἡσά παῖον παγαῖος πε, ἡαφῆαεν φῶν ἔχων ἂν πε. ¹² οὐ πε ἐτ ἐρ κῶλιν ἡμοι πε, ἡταῖ ῥο ἐπαῖον ἡἀγαθός, ἡτεφῶνρπ ἡνι ἡοῦνιῶτ ἡζαρμα ἡοῦνι, ἡταταλο ἡπαῖον ἡσῆφ ἐρῶν, ἡτεφῶντῆμ τῆπ ἡφῶν ἐπτηρῶ, ἡταθρῶν ὀλῶ ἦεν τῶαρζ ἐτ ἡχῶφῶν ἡῆντῶ, ἐνιτοπος ἡτε πεμτον, οὐδὲ ἡτεφῶνπ ἡεν ἡααγγελος ἡάσῶματος; ¹³ ἀλλὰ εἴθε τῆπαρῆσις ἡτε ἄδამ ἂ ἡαι ἡῶτ ἡ ἐχεν τῆμετρῶνι τῆρς ἡεν ται ἡῶτ ἡἀνατῆ ἡτε φῶν. ¹⁴ ἐφῶσον ἂνοκ τῆρ φορῖν ἡτῶαρζ ἡρεφῶν-ῆσι, ῥῶτ πε ἡταῆμ τῆπ ἡφῶν ἡῆντς ἡα πῆλασμα ἐτ ἡῶαμῖον, ῥῖνα | ἡταῆαι ἡῶν.

the command of God that he does, but Adam – he did not do the will of my Father but rather wrought transgression, until my Father was angry with him, in that he obeyed his wife, and was disobedient to my good Father, until he brought death upon all flesh. ¹¹ If Adam had not been disobedient to my good Father, he would not have brought death upon him. ¹² What is there that hinders me from asking my good Father to send me a great chariot of light, that I may set my father Joseph thereon, that he may not taste death at all; and that I may cause him to be taken up in the flesh in which he was born, to the places of rest, and that he may dwell with my angels that have no body? ¹³ But, because of the transgression of Adam, this great trouble has come on all mankind, and this great necessity of death. ¹⁴ Inasmuch as I wear the flesh that suffers, I must taste death in it, for the creature that I have made, in order that I may have mercy on them.”

¹¹ See #2.

¹² In place of ‘asking’, Robinson has ‘beseeching’.

¹³ See #2.

¹⁴ The literal translation of ‘the creature’ is ‘the thing formed’.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 29

¹ ΝΑΙ ΕΙΧΩ ΜΩΟΥ, ΕΙΕΡ ΑΜΑΛΗΧ - ΕΒΟΥΝ ΕΠΑΙΩΤ ΙΩΣΗΦ, ΕΙΡΙΜΙ ΕΡΟΦ. ² ΑΓΑΟΥΩΝ ΜΦΡΟ ΜΠΙΜΖΑΥ, ΑΥΧΩ ΜΠΕΦΩΜΑ ΜΗΝΤΥ ΗΑΤΕΝ ΠΩΜΑ ΜΙΑΚΩΒ ΠΕΦΙΩΤ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ Α ΠΕΦΧΩΚ-ΕΒΟΛ ΩΖΩΠΙ ΗΕΝ ΡΙΑ ΜΡΟΜΠΙ, ΟΥΟΖ ΜΠΕ ΟΥΝΑΧΖΙ ΝΟΥΩΤ ΩΩΦ ΗΕΝ ΡΩΦ, ΟΥΔΕ ΜΠΕ ΝΕΦΒΑΛ ΕΡ ΑΘΟΥΩΙΝΙ, ΑΛΛΑ ΝΑΡΕ ΤΕΦΖΟΡΑCΙC ΟΝΙ ΝΘΑ ΟΥΚΟΥΧΙ ΠΑΛΟC. ⁴ ΜΠΕΦΧΑ ΧΟΜ ΕΒΟΛ ΕΝΕΖ, ΑΛΛΑ ΝΑΦΕΡ ΖΩΒ ΠΕ ΗΕΝ ΨΤΕΧΝΗ ΜΤΕ ΨΜΕΤΖΑΜΩΕ ΩΩ ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΕΤ ΑΦΕΝΚΟΤ ΗΕΝ ΠΩΩΝΙ ΕΤΕΦΝΑΜΟΥ ΜΗΝΤΥ.

¹ As I was saying this, and embraced my father Joseph, and wept for him, ² they opened the door of the tomb and laid his body in it by the body of Jacob his father. ³ And his death took place in his hundred and eleventh year. And not a single tooth in his mouth was destroyed, nor were his eyes without light, but his sight was like that of a young child. ⁴ He never put away *his* strength, but he was working at the trade of carpentry until the day he lay down with the sickness with which he should die.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 29

- ¹ Throughout his text, Robinson capitalizes pronouns that refer to Jesus.
² That Joseph's father's name was Jacob is also attested elsewhere in apocryphal writings.
³ Another reading for '*his death*' is '*his consummation*'.
⁴ The MS does not have '*his*' before '*strength*', here following Robinson.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 30

¹ ἄΝΟΝ ΔΕ ἮΑ ΝΙΑΠΟCΤΟΛΟC ἮΕΝ ΠΧΙΝΘΕΡΕΝ CΩΤΕΜ ἘΝΑΙ ἸΤΟΤΥ ΜΠΕΝΟΩΤΗΡ ΑΝΡΑΩΙ, ΟΥΟΖ ΑΝΤΩΟΥΝΟΥ ἮΕΝ ΤΟΥΝΟΥ, ΑΝΟΥΩΩΤ ἘΧΕΝ ΝΕΦΧΙΧ ΝΕΜ ΝΕΦCΑΛΑΧ ΕΠΡΑΩΙ ΕΝΧΩ ἸΜΟC ΧΕ ΤΕΝΩΕΠ ΖΜΟΤ ἸΤΟΤΚ, ΠΕΝCΩΤΗΡ ἸΑΓΑΘΟC, ΧΕ ΑΚΑΙΤΕΝ ἸΕΜΠΩΑ ΝCΩΤΕΜ ἘΝΑΙ CΑΧΙ ἸΩΚῃ ΕΒΟΛΖΙ ΤΟΤΚ, ΠΕΠCΟΙC ² ΑΛΛΑ ΤΕΝΟΙ ΝΩΦΗΡΙ ἸΜΟΚ Ω ΠΕΝCΩΤΗΡ ἸΑΓΑΘΟC ΧΕ ΕΘΒΕ ΟΥ ἘΝΩΧ ΝΕΜ ἸΛΙΑC, ΑΚΕΡ ΧΑΡΙΖΕCΘΕ ΝΩΟΥ ἸΤΜΕΤΑΘΜΟΥ, ΟΥΟΖ | ΩΑ ΤΝΟΥ CΕ ΧΗ ἮΕΝ ἸΑΓΑΘΟΝ, ΕΥΩΟΠ ἮΕΝ ΤCΑΡΖ ΕΤ ΑΥΧΦΩΟΥ ἸῆΗΤC, ΩΑ ΤΝΟΥ, ἸΠΕ ΤΟΥCΑΡΖ ΝΑΥ ΕΠΤΑΚΟ, ΠΙῆΕΛΛΟ ΔΕ ἸΘΟΟΥ ΕΤ CΜΑΡΩΟΥΤ ΙΩCΗΦ ΠΙΖΑΜΩΕ, ΦΗ ΕΤ ΑΚΤ ΝΑΥ ἸΠΑΙ ΝΙΩΤ ἸΤΑΙΟ, Ἐ ΑΚΜΟΥΤ ἘΡΟΟΥ ΝΑΚ ἸΙΩΤ, ΟΥΟΖ ΑΚCΩΤΕΜ ἸCΩΟΥ ἮΕΝ ΖΩΒ ΝΙΒΕΝ. ³ ΟΥΟΖ ΑΚΖΟΝΖΕΝ ἘΤΟΤΕΝ ΕΚΧΩ ἸΜΟC ΝΑΝ ΧΕ ΔΙΩΑΝ Τ ΖΙ ΘΗΠΟΥ ΧΟΜ. ΟΥΟΖ ἸΤΑΟΥΩΡΠ ἘΧΩΤΕΝ ἸΠΙΩΩ ἸΤΕ ΠΑΙΩΤ. ἘΤΕ ΦΑΙ ΠΕ ΠΕΠΑΡΑΚΛΗΤΟΝ, ΠΙΠΝΕΥΜΑ ΕΘ ΟΥΑΒ, ἸΤΑΟΥΕΡΠΘΗΝΟΥ ἘΖΙΩΙΩ ἸΠΠΕΥΑΓΓΕΛΙΟΝ ΕΘ ΟΥΑΒ, ἸΤΕΤΕΝΖΙΩΙΩ ΖΩΟΥ ἸΠΑΜΕΝΡΙΤ ἸΙΩΤ ΙΩCΗΦ, ⁴ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ΧΩ ἸΝΑΙ CΑΧΙ ἸΩΝῃ ἮΕΝ ΤΔΙΔΘΗΚΝ ἸΤΕ ΠΕΦΧΙΝΙ ΕΒΟΛῃΕΝ CΩΜΑ, ⁵ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ΩΩ ἸΝΙCΑΧΙ ἸΤΕ ΤΑΙ ΔΙΔΘΗΚΗ ἮΕΝ ΝΙΕΖΟΟΥ ἸΩΑΙ ΝΕΜ ΝΙΕΖΟΟΥ ΕΤ ΤΑΙΗΟΥΤ, ⁶ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ἘΝΕ

¹ But we the apostles, when we heard these things from our Saviour, rejoiced; and we arose straight away, and saluted his hands and his feet, rejoicing and saying, "We thank you, our good Saviour, that you have made us worthy to hear these words of life from you, our Lord. ² But we wonder at you, O our good Saviour, why to Enoch and to Elijah you granted immortality; and until now they are among the good *things*, dwelling in the flesh in which they were born, and until now their flesh has not seen corruption. ³ But the old man, he that is blessed, Joseph the carpenter, to whom you have given this great honour, having called him your father – and you obeyed him in all things; and you commanded us, saying to us, "When I clothe you with power, and send on you the promise of my Father, even the Comforter, the Holy Spirit, and send you to preach the holy Gospel, see that you preach him also, my beloved father Joseph." ⁴ And again, "Speak these words of life in the testament of his going forth from the body." ⁵ And again, "Read the words of this testament on the feast days and on the honourable days." ⁶ And again, "No man who has not been

DEATH OF JOSEPH 30

¹ Another reading for 'saluted' is 'worshipped'.

² In place of 'Elijah', Robinson has 'Elias' (following the MS – Ἰλίας).

³ Throughout the book, Robinson has 'Holy Ghost' in place of 'Holy Spirit'.

⁴ Cf. Ac 5:20.

⁵ Presumably, this verse refers *specifically* to the Feast Day of St Joseph.

⁶ The purpose of discrimination against the (partially) illiterate is not clear.

ΡΩΜΙ ΕΤΕ ΜΠΟΥΤΣΑΒΟΥ ΕΣΤΑΙ ΗΚΑΛΩΣ, ΩΤΙ ΗΤΑΙ ΔΙΔΘΗΚΗ ΉΕΝ
ΝΙΕΖΟΥ ΝΩΙΑ, ⁷ ΟΥΟΖ ΟΝ ΧΕ ΦΗ ΕΘ ΝΑΩΛΙ ΕΒΟΛΉΕΝ ΝΑΙ ΣΑΧΙ
ΙΕ ΗΤΕΥΤΟΥΖΟ ΕΡΩΟΥ ΖΩΣΔΕ ΗΤΕΥΟΠΤ Η|ΡΕΥΧΕ-ΜΕΘΝΟΥΧ,
†ΝΑΣΙ ΜΠΩΙΩ ΜΜΟΥ ΗΧΩΛΕΜ – ⁸ ΟΥΟΖ ΤΕΝΟΝ ΗΩΦΗΡΙ ΧΕ
ΙΣΧΕΝ ΠΙΕΖΟΥ ΕΤ ΑΥΧΦΟΚ ΉΕΝ ΒΗΘΕΕΜ. ΑΚΜΟΥ† ΕΡΟΥ ΗΙΩΤ
ΝΑΚ ΚΑΤΑ ΣΑΡΖ, ΧΕ ΜΠΕΚΩΨ ΝΑΥ ΗΘΟΥ ΗΟΥΜΕΤΑΘΜΟΥ ΗΤΕΚ†
ΝΑΥ ΗΟΥΩΝΉ ΨΑ ΕΝΕΖ.

taught to write well shall read this testament on the feast days.”
⁷ And again, “He who takes away from these words, or adds to
them, so that he accounts me a liar, I will take vengeance on him
quickly.” ⁸ And we wonder that, since the day that you were
born in Bethlehem, you called him your father according to
flesh; *and yet* that you have not promised even him immortality
and given him life for ever.”

⁷ In place of ‘takes’ and ‘adds’, Robinson has ‘shall take’ and ‘shall add’, respectively.

⁸ The words, ‘and yet’, following Robinson, are not present in the MS.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 31

¹ αφερ ογω νχε πενσωτηρ πεχαφ ναν χε τἀποφασις ετ ἀ παιωτ ερ ἀποφανιν ἡμος ἡα ἄδαν, σνακνωρφ αν ηπιναυ ετ αφερ ατσωτεμ ἡσα νεφεντολη. ² ἀρεωαν παιωτ ερ αποφανιν ἐχεν πιρωμι χε φναερ δικεος. ωαφωωπι ναφ ἡσotπi. ³ ἀρεωαν πιρωμι σωφ μενρε νιζβνογι ἡτε πιλιὰβολος ἡεν πεφoγωω ἡτεφερ nobi, ἡτεφχαφ, ἡτεφερ ογνιωτ ἡαρι, μη φσωρογν αν χε φννογ ἐβρη ἐνεφχις, ἐωωπ φναερ μετανοιν αν; ⁴ ἐωωπ on ἀρεωαν ογαι ερ ογνιωτ ἡαρι, ἐρε νεφζβνογι νανευ, νεφπραζις ετ ipi ἡμοφ ἡβello. ⁵ αφωαν ναγ δε on ἐογαι εφτακο ἡμεφμωιτ, ωαφoρε πεφάρι ερ κογχι, φαι πε πιρητ ἐ ωαφoλογ ἡεν τφαωι ἡτε νογέροογ. ⁶ πλην νιπροφητιὰ τηρογ ετ ἀ παιωτ χoτογ, σεναχωκ-ἐβολ | ἐχεν τμετρωμι, ἡτε ρωβ νιβεν ωωπι ἡμωογ. ⁷ ογορ on ἀτετενταμοι εωβε ἐνωχ νεμ ἡλιας χε σεονῃ ἡεν τσαρζ ετ αχχφωογ ἡῃητς, εωβε ιωσφ δε ρωφ παιωτ κατα σαρζ, χε εωβε ογ ἡπεκχαφ ἡεν τσαρζ ωα τνογ; – ⁸ ἐνε ετ αφερ ογoβα ἡρομπι πε, ἀννηκη

¹ Our Saviour answered us, saying “The sentence that my good Father passed against Adam will not be made of no effect, *which he passed* at the time he was disobedient to his commandments. ² If my Father passes sentence on the man that he shall be righteous, he becomes his chosen one. ³ If the man indeed loves the works of the devil by his *own* will, and sins, and he is suffered to spend a long life, does he not know that he is coming into his hands, if he does not repent? ⁴ If again, one spends a long life, his works being good, his deeds make him *an* old man. ⁵ But if again, he sees one corrupting his way, he makes his life short. This is the manner in which he takes them away in the midst of their days. ⁶ But all the prophecies my Father has spoken shall be fulfilled on mankind, and all things shall happen to them. ⁷ And again you have told me concerning Enoch and Elijah, *saying*, ‘They are living in the flesh in which they were born.’ But concerning Joseph also, my father according to flesh, *you have asked*, ‘Why have you not left him in the flesh until now? ⁸ If he had lived ten

DEATH OF JOSEPH 31

- ¹ Robinson opens, “Our Saviour answered and said to us.”
- ² Literally translated, the verse ends, “he becomes chosen to him.”
- ³ The MS does not include the word, ‘own’, here following Robinson.
- ⁴ The MS does not have an article before ‘old man’.
- ⁵ The literal translation of ‘takes them away’ is ‘takes them up’.
- ⁶ After ‘prophecies’, Robinson has ‘that’.
- ⁷ In place of ‘Elijah’, Robinson has ‘Elias’ (following the MS – ἡλιας).
- ⁸ The MS does not have the word, ‘yet’.

ἐροῦ πε ἐθρεῖ μοῦ. ⁹ †ἄω ἡμος νῶτεν, ὦ ναηλος ἐθ
οὔαβ, ἄε σοπ νιβεν ἐρε ἐνωχ νημ ἡλιας νερ φμεγί μφοῦ,
ἐρνωοῦ. πε ε ἀγκην ἐμοῦ, ἡσερ-ἐβολ ἐται νιω† ἡἀναγκη
ετ χη νωοῦ ἐβρη, ἡαλιςτα ἐρε νη ἐτεμναῦ ναμοῦ βεν
οὔεροοῦ ἡωθορτερ νημ ρο† νημ ωω νημ ἀπγλη νημ ἡκαρ
ἡρητ. ¹⁰ παντιχριστος γαρ ναβωτεβ ἡπαι β ἡρωμ,
ἡτεφсетφ πογсноφ ριχεν πκαρι εθε οὔζεστης ἡμοῦ εθε
νιχφιο ετ οὔνατητοῦ ναφ εγσορι μμοῦ.

thousand years, *yet* must he die.’ ⁹ I say to you, O my holy
members, that every time Enoch and Elijah remember death, they
would willingly have died already, that they might escape this
great necessity that is laid down for them; especially as those men
will die in a day of confusion and of fear and of shouting and of
threatening and of grief. ¹⁰ For, the antichrist shall kill these two
men and shed their blood on the earth for a pot of water, because
of the rebukes that they shall give him, reproving him.”

⁹ In place of ‘Elijah’, Robinson has ‘Elias’ (following the MS – ἡλιας).

¹⁰ A ‘pot of water’ is symbolic of something held in little regard.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 32

¹ ἀνερ οὐω, πεχάν ναϥ ἄε πενβοῖς οὐορ πεννοϥ†, νιμ παῖ
βῆρωμι ἐτ ἀκχός εὐβητοϥ ἄε ἐρε πωρηι ἡπτακο ναῶωτεβ
ἡμωοϥ εὐβε οὐζεσθῆς ἡμωοϥ; | ² πεχε πενσώτηρ ἡσοϥς
οὐορ πενωῆς ναν ἄε ἐνωχ πε νεμ ἡλιας. ³ ἄσωωπι ἄε ἥεν
πχινῶρε πενσώτηρ ἡαγαῶος ἄε ναι ναν, ἀνοϥνοϥ οὐορ
ἀνραωι, ἀνωεπ ρμοτ οὐορ ἀν† ὠοϥ ναϥ, ἡῶοϥ πενβοῖς
οὐορ πεννοϥ† πενσώτηρ ἡσοϥς πχριστός, φαι ἐτε ἐβολρι
τοτϥ ἐρε ὠοϥ νοβεν νεμ ταῖό νοβεν ἐρ πρεπι ἡφίωτ
νεμαϥ νεμ πιπνεϥμα εὐ οὐαβ ἡρεϥτανῶο, †νοϥ νεμ ἡχοϥ
νιβεν νεμ ωα ἐνερ ἡτε νιένερ τηροϥ. ἀμην.

ἀρι παμεϥι ἀνοκ πιελαχι πιρεϥερνοβι πιταλεπωρος ἐτχονε ἥεν πωικ
ἡτε νεϥνοβι ραπιπ πῶς ναι ναϥ ἐμην [ἀννε ἀμιν?] ἀιϥῆαι πσοϥκῆ
ἡπιαβοτ ἐπιπ χρ ἡρ ῥπο, _††ρο οὐορ †τωρπ ἡμωωτεν, ναῶς βαιο†
πικληρ νεμ μιλά ἡτε παῶς πῶαββα

¹ We answered and said to him, “Our Lord and our God, who *are* these two men concerning whom you have said, ‘The son of perdition shall kill them for a pot of water?’” ² Our Saviour Jesus and our Life said to us, “They are Enoch and Elijah.” ³ Now it came to pass, when our good Saviour had said these things to us, we were glad and we rejoiced, and we gave thanks and we glorified him, our Lord and our God, our Saviour Jesus Christ, through whom all glory and all honour is due to the Father and him and the Holy Spirit, giver of life, now and always and unto the ages of all the ages. Amen.

Remember me, the least, the sinner, the wretched one, stinking in the pit of his sins, *even* Hapip. Lord, have mercy on him. Amen. I wrote *this on* the twenty-eighth of the month Epep, in the year of the martyrs seven hundred and eighty-three.

DEATH OF JOSEPH 32

¹ See #31:1 on the ‘*pot of water*’.

² In place of ‘*Elijah*’, Robinson has ‘*Elias*’ (following the *MS* – ἡλιας).

³ The 2nd paragraph is written as a marginal note in the *MS*. Our transcription is far from certain, as Lagarde presents it only in his footnotes, which are barely legible.